

ROOM FOR 10,000:
GOVT'S HOSTEL PLAN **P3**



CHHATTISGARH CM URGES CITIZENS
TO SUPPORT LOCAL ARTISANS **P5**

'WIDOW'S BAY' BREAKS
EMMY'S RECORD **P14**



TARGETS LARGE MERCHANT PAYMENTS, SPARES EVERYDAY USERS

Centre ends free UPI era for merchants

Sets 0.4% fee on UPI payments above Rs 2,000, capped at Rs 300 from Oct 15

SHASHWAT SAJAL
New Delhi, September 15

The government on Tuesday announced a new transaction fee on certain Unified Payments Interface (UPI) merchant payments, bringing an end to nearly six years of a fully free UPI system for merchants. From October 15, person-to-merchant (P2M) transactions above Rs 2,000 will attract a merchant discount rate (MDR) of 0.4 per cent, with the charge capped at Rs 300 for payments of Rs 75,000 and above.

The new framework, however, keeps person-to-person (P2P) payments completely free, regardless of the transaction amount. The government has also retained zero MDR on small-value merchant payments of up to Rs 2,000.

The Finance Ministry said the new charges would apply only to P2M transactions exceeding the Rs 2,000 threshold. "A nominal merchant discount rate (MDR) of 0.4 per cent will be

UPI charges from Oct 15: 0.4% MDR on merchant payments above Rs 2,000, capped at Rs 300 for payments of Rs 75,000+

Small payments protected: P2M transactions up to Rs 2,000 remain free

P2P stays free: Person-to-person transfers remain zero-charge, regardless of amount

Only 4% affected: Government estimates roughly 4% of merchant transactions will face MDR

Essential sectors: Railways, telecom, insurance, fuel and farm inputs face flat Rs 5 MDR above Rs 2,000

Utility, education: Electricity, water, piped gas and education payments above Rs 2,000 also attract Rs 5 MDR

Investments: Mutual funds, securities, stockbrokers and dealers face 0.02% MDR, capped at Rs 300

Small vendors: Merchants receiving up to Rs 1 lakh/month via QR pay nothing

No individual limits: No monthly quotas or volume caps on free UPI transactions for individuals

AutoPay stays free: Recurring bills, OTT subscriptions and investments carry no fee

Credit-linked UPI: RuPay Credit Card on UPI and pre-sanctioned credit lines follow separate card rules

Customer pays no extra: Merchants cannot add this fee to the bill; UPI apps also cannot charge hidden or platform fees

Who pays?
THE MERCHANT PAYS THE FEE TO THE ACQUIRING BANK, WHICH SHARES IT WITH BANKS AND UPI APP PROVIDERS

levied on P2M transactions above Rs 2,000," it said, adding that the commission would be distributed among payment ecosystem partners, including banks and app providers.

P2P transfers account for 37 per cent of UPI's transaction volume and 70 per cent of its value. Meanwhile, transactions of up to Rs 2,000 make up more than 95 per cent of total

P2M transaction volume. As a result, the government estimates that only around 4 per cent of merchant transactions will actually be affected by the new MDR. The new system also

provides separate rates for certain sectors. Railways, telecom, insurance, fuel and agricultural inputs will face a flat MDR of Rs 5 per transaction above Rs 2,000. These sectors account for

nearly 17 per cent of P2M transaction volume but about 46 per cent of its transaction value.

Government utility bill payments, including electricity, water and piped gas, as well as educational payments such as school tuition and university fees above Rs 2,000, will also be charged a flat Rs 5 MDR. Transactions below the Rs 2,000 threshold in these categories will remain free.

Payments involving mutual funds, securities, stockbrokers and dealers will carry a much lower MDR of 0.02 per cent, subject to a maximum of Rs 300. The government said the lower rate would keep the cost of such transactions low while supporting retail participation in formal financial markets.

For ordinary merchants, the 0.4 per cent rate means a Rs 3,000 purchase would result in an MDR of Rs 12, while a Rs 50,000 payment would attract Rs 200.

CONTINUED ON P4

Delhi doubles ASHA workers' monthly incentive to Rs 6,000

6,725 workers to benefit

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 15

In a move aimed at strengthening Delhi's primary healthcare network and improving the financial security of front-line health workers, the Delhi Cabinet on Tuesday approved doubling the fixed monthly incentive for ASHA workers from Rs 3,000 to Rs 6,000.

The decision, taken at a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, will benefit all 6,725 ASHA workers currently working in the capital. Other incentives available to them will continue as before.

Gupta said ASHA workers form an important link between communities and the public healthcare system, with their work extending from household visits and vaccination awareness to maternal and child healthcare.

"ASHA workers are an important link in Delhi's primary healthcare sys-



KEY POINTS

- » Other existing incentives will continue unchanged
- » Each ASHA generally serves around 2,000 people
- » They cover nearly 400 families each

tem. They visit households to provide health-related information, encourage families to get vaccinated and assist with services related to the care of pregnant women and new mothers," Gupta said.

She said each ASHA worker generally serves around 2,000 people or nearly 400 families, making their contribution significant at

CONTINUED ON P4

In talks with Xi, Modi emphasised ties must be guided by 3 mutuals

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 15

Prime Minister Narendra Modi told Chinese President Xi Jinping that India-China ties should follow "three mutuals": mutual respect, sensitivity and interest, the MEA said Tuesday. During their Saturday meeting on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, both leaders discussed Taiwan and Tibet, besides



border issues. Modi said peace and tranquillity along the LAC remain essential for bilateral ties. The meeting came during efforts to rebuild relations strained by the eastern Ladakh standoff. **SEE P5**

India calls Pakistan's Azhar bounty a 'gimmick'
New Delhi, September 15

India on Tuesday rejected Pakistan's fresh announcement of a seven million rupees bounty for information on Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) chief Masood Azhar, calling on Islamabad to take concrete steps against terrorism. **CONTINUED ON P4**

India condemns Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, September 15

India on Tuesday condemned Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia's civilian infrastructure and economic assets, warning that such strikes could affect regional stability and the safety of international shipping through the Bab-el-Mandeb strait.

Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar had discussed the situation with Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud during their meeting on the sidelines of the BRICS summit on Sunday.

"The issue of the Houthis was also discussed," Jaiswal said, adding that India was "deeply concerned" about the worsening situation in the Red Sea region. He said attacks on Saudi sovereign territory were unacceptable and threatened freedom of navigation through Bab-el-Mandeb.

CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

No early release for Dara Singh

BHUBANESWAR: The Odisha government has rejected the plea of Hindutva activist Ravindra Pal alias Dara Singh for premature release from prison in the 1999 murder of Australian missionary Graham Staines and his two minor sons in Keonjhar, officials said on Tuesday. The decision was taken by the State Sentence Review Board (SSRB) **CONTINUED ON P4**

Three-week interim bail to Bhardwaj

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Tuesday granted three weeks' interim bail to Swatantra Bhardwaj, who is accused in an alleged assault involving the father of a Dalit student-activist during CJP protest at Jantar Mantar in June. Bhardwaj was arrested in Uttar Pradesh on September 5 and **CONTINUED ON P4**

GURUGRAM HIT-AND-RUN CASE

Gym owner, cousin nabbed

Stalking, attempt to murder charges added to FIR

MPOST BUREAU
Gurugram/Jaipur, September 15

A 33-year-old gym owner, accused of deliberately hitting a woman biker with his car on Gurugram's Golf Course Road, was arrested on Tuesday after a two-day search, police said. Kalyan Bainsla was booked for an attempt to murder, stalking and acts against a woman's modesty.

Bainsla and his cousin Lovneesh, 34, were arrested from Rajgarh in Rajasthan. Police said Bainsla had switched off his phone after speaking to the media and fled. Three teams were formed to trace him. Police also apprehended his associate Pramod, who allegedly helped him escape from Tikri **CONTINUED ON P4**

No sports activities, competitions in Delhi-NCR in Nov-Dec

Poor winter air quality cited as key concern

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 15

The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) has advised Delhi and the NCR states of Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan to avoid scheduling physical sports activities and competitions in November and December 2026, citing the deterioration in air quality typically seen during the winter months and its potential impact on children taking part **CONTINUED ON P4**

US confirms for 1st time it has weapons in space

China and Russia remain major space concerns

AGENCIES
Washington, Sep 15

The United States has for the first time publicly confirmed that it has deployed weapons in space, saying the systems are intended to protect American military forces from hostile actions by adversaries.

US Air Force Secretary Troy Meink made the disclosure on Monday at the annual Air, Space and Cyber Conference in Maryland. He said the US had fielded "on-orbit space control weapons capable of defending the Joint

TAKEAWAYS

- » Air Force Secretary Troy Meink disclosed the deployment
- » He cited "on-orbit space control weapons"
- » Weapons can defend US forces from hostile actions
- » Officials did not identify the weapons
- » Their location and operation remain undisclosed
- » Systems can support offensive and defensive missions

Force against hostile adversary action." **CONTINUED ON P4**

NSE Mainboard - Equity, REITs, InvITs

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NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public Offer of its Equity Shares and has filed a red herring prospectus dated September 10, 2026 with the RoC. The RHP is made available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the BRLMs i.e., Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited at <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>; JM Financial Limited at www.jmfi.com; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited at www.morganstanley.com/india; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited at <https://www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/globalpresence/india>; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited at www.business.hsbc.co.in; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited at www.jpmi.com; Anand Rathi Advisors Limited at www.anandrathiib.com; Avendus Capital Private Limited at www.avendus.com; Axis Capital Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in; DAM Capital Advisors Limited at www.damcapital.in; Equirus Capital Limited (formerly known as Equirus Capital Private Limited) at www.equirus.com; HDFC Bank Limited at www.hdfc.bank.in; ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com; IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited at www.idbicapital.com; IIFL Capital Services Limited (formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited) at www.iiflcapital.com; Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com; Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.nuvama.com; Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited at www.pantomathcapital.com; 360 ONE WAM Limited at www.360.one and SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.sbicaps.com, the website of BSE at www.bseindia.com and the website of our Company at www.nseindia.com. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risks, please see the section "Risk Factors" beginning on page 26 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP for making any investment decision but should only rely on the information included in the RHP filed by the Company with the RoC, the SEBI and the Stock Exchange.

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Bihar received less than 30 % of rainfall this year: CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Patna, September 15

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Tuesday said Bihar received less than 30 per cent of rainfall so far this year, but is still suffering a devastating flood due to heavy downpour in bordering states and neighbouring Nepal.

Choudhary was speaking at a programme where he transferred Rs 579.23 crore in relief assistance to the bank accounts of 8.27 lakh flood-affected families in 15 districts, each receiving Rs 7,000.

Around 49.72 lakh people have been affected by floods in the state, with several rivers flowing above their danger marks, the Disaster Management Department said.

Choudhary directed the district magistrates of the affected districts to prepare detailed reports on flood-related damage ahead of Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan's visit on Wednesday.

A central team led by Chouhan will visit the state to assess the flood situation.

The chief minister said water levels in the Ganga, Sone and Gandak rivers had risen following heavy rainfall in neighbouring Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh, besides incessant rain in the catchment areas of rivers flowing from Nepal into Bihar.

DRDO-INDUSTRY SYNERGY MEET

Defence sector cornerstone of 2047 vision of self-reliant India: Rajnath

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 15

Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday said technological leadership will determine strategic advantage in future warfare, asserting that “our imagination of today will become tomorrow’s military capabilities”.

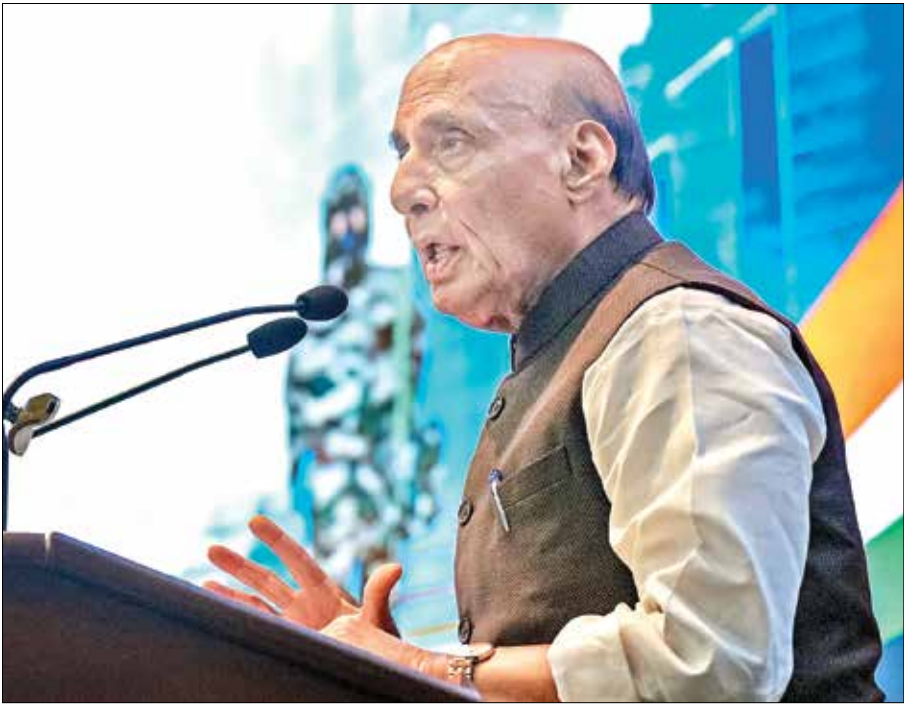
Addressing a DRDO-hosted event here, he said the vision of a Viksit Bharat by 2047 was not just about building an economically strong India but a “technologically self-reliant, socially inclusive, environmentally sustainable, and strategically secure India”.

The defence sector is the “cornerstone” of this vision, Singh said.

“By 2047, we have to achieve self-reliance in critical technologies, significant increase in indigenous content, multi-fold growth in defence exports, and we will have to ensure strong presence of India in global supply chain,” he said.

All this cannot be achieved without collaboration, he said, urging greater partnership among all stakeholders in the sector.

The DRDO-Industry Synergy Meet -- ‘Vimarsh 2026’ -- was hosted at the DRDO Bhawan here.



Defence minister Rajnath Singh addresses the ‘VIMARSH 2026’ event at Dr. D.S. Kothari Auditorium, DRDO Bhawan, in New Delhi, Tuesday

PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Singh said the partnership between the DRDO and industry should not be limited to production but should extend to research, design, testing, certification and the entire manufacturing value chain
- » Along with big industries, MSMEs and start-ups should also be made an integral component of the value chain, Singh said

Singh said the partnership between the DRDO and industry should not be limited to production but

in future warfare and urged the sector to accelerate technological innovation.

“Today, we are seeing how AI can be used to render an image which seems to be of the 80s (referring to the viral ‘in the 80s’ AI-driven trend online). Joy would be when you can present an image of the future 40-50 years ahead,” Singh said. He urged stakeholders in the Indian defence sector to work in that direction. “How we wish to see India in 40-50 years, the imagination itself will give new energy to our enthusiasm,” he said.

Companies investing in new and emerging technologies will emerge as technology leaders in the future, Singh said.

“We need to not just imagine the technology of the future, but we need to develop the technology of the future, today.

Because, in future warfare, only that country will be able to leverage a strategic advantage, who will lead the technology. And, our imagination of today will become tomorrow’s military capabilities,” he said.

The event was attended by several senior DRDO officials and representatives of defence industry firms, among others.

India-US joint military exercise ‘Yudh Abhyas’ gets underway

The opening ceremony of the 22nd edition of the exercise was held at Auli Foreign Training Node

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi September 15

A joint military exercise -- ‘Yudh Abhyas’ -- involving the troops of Indian and US armies, which seeks to bolster interoperability among the two forces and address emerging challenges while further strengthening the bilateral defence partnership, kicked off on Tuesday.

The opening ceremony of the 22nd edition of the exercise was held at Auli Foreign Training Node in Uttarakhand.

The exercise is simultaneously being conducted at Auli and Mahajan Field Firing Range in Rajasthan, the Indian defence ministry said.

“The exercise is aimed at enhancing the joint military capability of both armies for employment of Integrated Battle Groups in mountainous and semi-mountainous terrain, with emphasis on infantry-dominated operations. It will strengthen interoperability, facilitate exchanges of best operational practices and strengthen joint planning and execution,” it said in

‘THE EXERCISE IS AIMED AT ENHANCING THE JOINT MILITARY CAPABILITY OF BOTH ARMIES FOR EMPLOYMENT OF INTEGRATED BATTLE GROUPS IN MOUNTAINOUS AND SEMI-MOUNTAINOUS TERRAIN’

a statement.

Maj Gen Amaresh Gunjan, General Officer Commanding, 14 Infantry Division and Col Benjamin Jackman, Commander, 1st Infantry Brigade Combat Team, 11th Airborne Division, US Army, addressed the participating contingents comprising 600 personnel from each side, the ministry said.

Technology infusion will form a key focus area. The training will include the employment of drones and autonomous systems for surveillance and reconnaissance, as well as demonstration of contemporary weapon systems, which will be undertaken at Mahajan Field Firing Ranges, officials said.

From page 1

Centre ends

On a Rs 1 lakh transaction, the percentage-based charge would otherwise be Rs 400, but the Rs 300 cap would apply.

The government has also introduced measures aimed at preventing the MDR from becoming a direct cost for consumers. UPI app providers will not be allowed to impose platform fees or hidden charges, while banks have been advised to ensure that merchants do not transfer MDR costs to customers. “UPI app providers are explicitly prohibited from levying platform fees or hidden charges,” the Finance Ministry said. “Banks have been advised to ensure that merchants do not pass MDR charges to customers for UPI payments.”

Small merchants will continue to receive broader protection. Vendors receiving up to Rs 1 lakh a month through UPI QR codes under the Person-to-Person-Merchant (P2PM) framework will continue to pay zero MDR on all transactions. They will not need to obtain GST registration or replace their existing QR infrastructure.

Acquiring banks will monitor incoming payments through a velocity check. A merchant that crosses the Rs 1 lakh monthly threshold for three consecutive months will shift to the standard P2M category. The zero-MDR provision will also cover QR payments in rural and semi-urban areas.

The new MDR does not cover every form of UPI-linked payment. Direct payments from a user’s bank account to a merchant account will fall under the framework, while credit-linked transactions, including RuPay Credit Cards on UPI and pre-sanctioned credit lines, will follow separate card rules. Recurring payments made through UPI Mandates or AutoPay, such as utility bills, OTT subscriptions and recurring investments, will carry no MDR.

There will also be no monthly quota or volume-based limit on free UPI transactions for individuals. Existing daily transaction limits of Rs 1 lakh to Rs 5 lakh, depending on the category, will continue to serve as risk-management measures.

The move follows sustained pressure from parts of the payments and banking industry to restore merchant charges. The Payments Council of India, whose members include Airtel Payments Bank, Amazon Pay, Google Pay, Cashfree and Jio Payments Bank, had approached the Prime Minister’s Office seeking a review of the zero-MDR policy. Banks had separately sought charges for merchants with annual turnover exceeding Rs 40 lakh.

The Reserve Bank of India and the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) have also previously called for a reconsideration of the zero-MDR arrangement. RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra, while discussing the issue after a recent monetary policy announcement, said, “someone has to pay the cost”, while making clear that the decision on MDR ultimately rests with the government.

Delhi doubles

the community level. They also participate in Health and Nutrition Days, health awareness programmes, surveys and community meetings.

The chief minister highlighted the role played by ASHA workers during the Covid-19 pandemic, when they continued providing healthcare-related services at the grassroots level.

“The Delhi Government has been continuously discussing an increase in the remuneration of ASHA workers. It was among the government’s priorities, and the decision has now been taken,” Gupta said.The increase in the fixed monthly incentive will apply to all ASHA workers currently engaged in Delhi. The government said the enhanced payment was aimed at recognising their contribution while providing them greater financial support.

Gupta said the move would also help improve the morale of ASHA workers and encourage them to continue their work with greater commitment.

“This increase in the monthly incentive is an important step towards recognising ASHA workers’ contribution and ensuring their financial security. It will boost their enthusiasm for their work and help them continue their services,” she said.

ASHA workers are involved in several community-level health activities, including promoting

immunisation, supporting pregnant women and new mothers, disseminating health information and connecting families with healthcare services.

The government said improving their working conditions and financial security would contribute to making primary healthcare delivery more effective in Delhi.Gupta said the decision was also linked to the government’s broader focus on women’s economic empowerment.

“Strengthening the financial security and working conditions of ASHA workers is our priority. Their contribution at the grassroots level is vital to ensuring continuity in healthcare services and making primary healthcare in Delhi more effective,” the chief minister said.

India calls

“Such gimmicks and hoodwinking by Pakistan is nothing new,” External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said. He called the announcement “phoney” and said it was of no consequence.

Azhar remains on Pakistan’s Federal Investigation Agency’s Red Book of most-wanted terrorists and is wanted in India for the 2001 Parliament attack, 2008 Mumbai attacks, 2016 Pathankot airbase assault and 2019 Pulwama bombing. He was designated a UN global terrorist in May 2019.Pakistan has claimed for years that Azhar fled to Afghanistan, but the Taliban government rejected the claim last week, saying he was not in the country.

The bounty announcement comes ahead of a Financial Action Task Force review of Pakistan’s counter-terror financing efforts. Pakistan was on the FATF grey list from 2018 to 2022 over shortcomings, including action against JeM and Lashkar-e-Taiba. It remains under Asia/Pacific Group review over efforts to arrest Azhar.

Houthi attacks

The Iran-backed Houthi group, which operates mainly from Yemen, has targeted Saudi Arabia’s East-West oil pipeline, an important route for crude exports. The pipeline has gained importance as a bypass after disruption to shipping through the Strait of Hormuz.

Jaiswal said India continues to receive energy supplies from the region and called for an early

return of peace and stability.

He also addressed the case of an Indian seafarer missing after an attack on a Panama-flagged vessel off Oman last week. The ship was carrying 14 Indian nationals, of whom 13 have been rescued. Jaiswal thanked Omani authorities for their efforts and said search and rescue operations for the missing Indian were continuing.

India also called attacks on commercial vessels, seafarers, civilians and civilian infrastructure unacceptable, urging the restoration of safe navigation and the uninterrupted movement of commerce through international waterways in the region.

Gym owner

Gurjar village in Palwal. The incident took place on Sunday when 27-year-old Shivani Chauhan, who uses the name ‘Siya’ on Instagram, was riding her Aprilia RS 457. Police said Bainsla, driving a Maruti Suzuki Ciaz, approached from behind and grazed her bike at speed, causing her to fall and skid on the road.

Gurugram Police Commissioner Sibash Kabiraj said an attempt-to-murder charge was added after officers examined Instagram videos and CCTV footage. DCP (East) Sandeep Kumar said the footage showed the car hitting the biker after an argument and that the victim told police she believed it was intentional.

Chauhan later joined the investigation and recorded her statement in court on Tuesday. Based on her complaint, police added Sections 109, 78 and 79 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, covering attempts to murder, stalking and acts against a woman’s modesty. A suo motu case had initially been registered at Sector 56 police station after Chauhan posted the video on September 14 without a formal complaint.Police said Bainsla also allegedly made obscene comments and stalked Chauhan. After his arrest, he reportedly tried to escape while being taken into custody on the pretext of urinating, fell and sustained injuries. He was given first aid at a hospital.

Bainsla’s lawyer, Naveen Bainsla, denied deliberate intent and said his client fled because he feared being attacked by a crowd. He alleged the bikers

were travelling at 120 to 160 kmph and claimed the videos were edited.

Police have impounded the car, which is registered in an acquaintance’s name. Both Bainsla and Lovneesh are being questioned and are expected to be produced before a Gurugram court for police remand.

US confirms

Neither Meink nor a US Space Force spokesperson provided details about the weapons, including their type, location or method of operation. The Space Force said the systems are designed for “space control”, which includes using both kinetic and non-kinetic means to disrupt or counter an adversary’s space capabilities.

“These capabilities can be employed for offensive and defensive purposes,” the Space Force said.The disclosure comes amid growing concern in Washington over the space capabilities of China and Russia. The US said in 2024 that Russia was developing a new anti-satellite weapon that could be launched from space, although the White House said at the time that the threat was not imminent.

The US Space Force said China is developing and operating space and counterspace systems as part of its military modernisation programme. It said Russia regards space as a warfighting domain and considers control of space important to future conflicts.

Military satellites play a major role in communications, surveillance and navigation, making them important to modern armed forces.

The militarisation of space dates back to the Cold War. The 1967 Outer Space Treaty prohibits placing weapons of mass destruction in orbit, but does not ban all forms of military activity or conventional weapons in space.Meink also said the Air Force was expanding its use of autonomous systems and could look “radically different” by 2032. He predicted one-way attack drones could replace artillery as the “primary killer” and said the US was increasing readiness against existing threats.

President Donald Trump established the US Space Force in 2019. The administration is also developing space capabilities linked to its “Golden Dome”

missile defence programme.

Delhi-NCR

in outdoor events. Competitions already scheduled for the two months may be rescheduled, the commission said in its September 10 advisory.

The advisory follows concerns raised by the Supreme Court in the MC Mehta vs Union of India & Ors case over children participating in physical sports competitions when air quality is poor or severe. On November 19, 2025, the court had asked CAQM to issue directions to Delhi-NCR schools to postpone sports and games planned for November and December.

Following the court’s observations, CAQM had consulted the Ministry of Education’s Department of School Education and Literacy, Delhi and NCR governments, Sports Authority of India, NCR pollution control boards and the Delhi Pollution Control Committee. The commission had subsequently advised governments to postpone such events based on air quality conditions at the venue.

For 2026, CAQM said it was reiterating its earlier advice and asked governments to ensure that no physical sports competitions are scheduled during November and December. Events already on school calendars can be shifted.

The commission also asked authorities to ensure students are not disadvantaged by rescheduling. It suggested providing alternative opportunities to participate in similar activities at a more suitable time, while taking into account their health and academic progress.

Dara Singh

at a special meeting on August 31, chaired by Additional Chief Secretary (Home) Hemant Sharma and attended by five other members. The board said it was “not inclined to recommend his premature release at this stage” in view of certain facts and circumstances.

Singh, 67, has spent more than 24 years in prison without remission. His plea had earlier been rejected by the SSB in 2016, 2019, 2020, 2022 and 2023, citing various grounds, including concerns over communal disturbance.

The board also noted that 200-250 people linked to the Dara Sena gathered outside

Keonjhar district jail on August 15 over his proposed release. Officials reported that provocative slogans were raised, though the report was considered inconclusive.

Singh was sentenced to death in 2003, but the Orissa High Court commuted it to life imprisonment in 2005, a decision upheld by the Supreme Court in 2011.

The Supreme Court will hear his plea again on September 17.

Bhardwaj

has since remained in judicial custody. The case relates to an incident during a protest organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) in June.

The bail proceedings saw both sides present sharply different accounts of the incident. Bhardwaj’s counsel, advocate Umesh Sharma, argued that the arrest was politically motivated and maintained that the complainant had himself assaulted Bhardwaj during the confrontation.

Referring to a video of the incident, Sharma told the court, “The police are not able to see that video? It is clearly visible in this video that the complainant attacked me and I fell down”.

The defence also questioned the circumstances surrounding Bhardwaj’s arrest under provisions of the SC/ST Act. Sharma submitted that Bhardwaj had received a police notice on June 27 and appeared before investigators on June 29, following which he was permitted to leave.

“The police issued me a notice on June 27 to appear for questioning, and I appeared for questioning on June 29. After that, I was allowed to go. Then, after some political developments, I was arrested on September 4. After my arrest, a new FIR [under POCSO] was registered,” Sharma said.The complainant’s counsel, advocate Swati Khanna, opposed the plea, alleging that Bhardwaj had used casteist slurs during the incident. She further claimed that Bhardwaj had acknowledged in a video that he was responsible for attacking the complainant.

Delhi Police, meanwhile, told the court that the initial complaint did not contain any reference to a casteist slur. The SC/ST Act provisions were added later after such an allegation was included in a subsequent statement.

MPPOST

Briefs

CRPF's CoBRA gets woman IG

NEW DELHI: IPS officer Sanjukta Parasor has been appointed the Inspector General (IG) of the CRPF's special jungle warfare commando unit, CoBRA, the first woman to hold the post.

Parasor is a 2006-batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer from the Assam-Meghalaya cadre.

Ex-Andhra deputy CM Srinivas dies

AMARAVATI: Former Andhra Pradesh deputy Chief Minister A Kali Krishna Srinivas, popularly known as Alla Nani, died on Tuesday due to a heart attack, and TDP leaders, including Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu consoled the death.

Srinivas was 56.

"The sudden demise of Alla Nani Garu (Kali Krishna Srinivas), former Deputy Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh state, has deeply shocked me. It is heartbreaking that he passed away due to a heart attack at the young age of 56," CM Naidu said in a post on 'X'.

UP approves ethanol plant in Mathura

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet on Tuesday approved a proposal to set up an ethanol plant at a sugar mill in Chhata in Mathura district that has remained closed for 19 years, with the facility expected to produce 3.96 crore litres of ethanol annually.

The decision was taken at a meeting chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, at which 23 proposals were approved.

Resignation of IAS officer accepted

LUCKNOW: The Centre has accepted the resignation of 2013-batch IAS officer Divya Mittal, who quit the Uttar Pradesh cadre on August 30 citing personal reasons.

Mittal announced the acceptance of her resignation in a post on X around 11 pm on Monday. Along with the announcement, she quoted a line from poet Jaishankar Prasad's play Chandragupta: "The path of virtue lies ahead. Keep moving forward."

TDP, Sena back BJP on UCC call

NEW DELHI: After Home minister Amit Shah's assertion that a Uniform Civil Code will be implemented in all NDA-ruled states before 2029, key NDA partners TDP and Shiv Sena on Tuesday backed the BJP on the issue.

Another BJP ally JD(U) gave a guarded response, saying it will study the Uniform Civil Code Bill and will "not oppose it for no reason".

IN TALKS WITH PRESIDENT JINPING

Modi emphasised India-China ties must be guided by 3 mutuals

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 15

In his bilateral talks with Chinese President Xi Jinping, Prime Minister Narendra Modi stressed that both sides must show sensitivity to each other's core issues and let relations be guided by "three mutuals" - mutual respect, mutual sensitivity and mutual interest, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Tuesday.

The two leaders met on Saturday on the margins of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi during Xi's first visit to India in seven years.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal acknowledged that issues such as Taiwan and Tibet figured in the talks between the two leaders, as mentioned in a Chinese readout.

During the meeting, Modi told Xi that peace and tranquillity along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) remain an "essential" basis for the development of India-China relations, even as the two leaders welcomed "steady progress" in bilateral ties.

"The Prime Minister referred to Indian concerns as well, and underlined that both sides should show sensitivity to each other's core concerns and be guided by three mutuals - mutual respect, mutual interest and mutual sensitivity," Jaiswal said.

The spokesperson was



PM Narendra Modi during a bilateral meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping, in New Delhi

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The two leaders met on Saturday on the margins of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi during Xi's first visit to India in seven years
- » PM underlined that both sides should show sensitivity to each other's core concerns and be guided by three mutuals - mutual respect, mutual interest and mutual sensitivity, Jaiswal said

asked to comment on the Congress' criticism that New Delhi had not taken up the border situation with the Chinese side strongly while seeking to expand bilateral economic engagement.

Jaiswal said that issues relating to Taiwan and Tibet came up during the meeting.

The Chinese readout of the Modi-Xi meeting said

that "India's policy and position on issues relating to Taiwan and Tibet remain unchanged, and it will not allow any force to engage in anti-China activities on its territory".

On Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi's remarks that Modi and Xi reached an "important consensus" that India and China should be partners, Jaiswal said the Indian

side had already issued a detailed readout on the discussions.

In their talks, the two leaders reaffirmed that both countries should take a strategic and long-term perspective on their ties and that differences should not become disputes, the MEA had said on Saturday.

"The prime minister emphasised that peace and tranquillity in the border areas remain an essential basis for the continued development of bilateral relations," it said.

The Modi-Xi meeting took place amid efforts by the two sides to repair the ties that came under severe strain following the eastern Ladakh military standoff between the two sides.

Xi's visit to India came on the heels of several high-level exchanges, including the Special Representative dialogue in Beijing between National Security Advisor Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi, even as lingering concerns remain over aggressive Chinese military posturing along the Arunachal Pradesh sector.

The Chinese readout said India views its relations with China from a strategic and long-term perspective.

Xi mentioned four points for promoting bilateral ties, saying China and India are partners and not rivals.

Cong, BJP spar on UPI charge

Compromised PM surrendering again, alleges Rahul

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 15

Sparring over the imposition of a 0.4 per cent fee on UPI payments above Rs 2,000 to merchants, the Congress on Tuesday dubbed it as "Modi tax" and alleged that a "compromised" prime minister had "surrendered" to US pressure, while the BJP described the Opposition party as a "jhooth ki dukaan".

Ending nearly six years of a fully free Unified Payments Interface (UPI) network for merchants, the government on Tuesday introduced a 0.4 per cent transaction fee on payments above Rs 2,000, capped at Rs 300 for payments of Rs 75,000 and above, from October 15, while explicitly ring-fencing everyday person-to-person transfers from any charge.

Soon after the government notification, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi alleged that

CLOSER LOOK

- » The BJP hit back, accusing the Congress of spreading 'fake news' to create panic about UPI transaction charges and derail Digital India
- » Ramesh said the government had earlier claimed on August 6 that 'no decision has been taken on MDR'

the Modi government has quietly paved the way for imposing fees on UPI, while Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge said the Modi government's "loot" has now reached UPI.

The BJP hit back, accusing the Congress of spreading "fake news" to create panic about UPI transaction charges and derail Digital India.

BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari called the Opposition party a "jhooth ki dukaan (shop of lies)" and said the government has made it absolutely clear that MDR charges will not be levied on consumers.

The ruling party noted that transfers to family

and friends remain free and small vendors are protected by the exemption of Rs 1 lakh per month, while merchants pay 0.4 per cent on payments above Rs 2,000, capped at Rs 300 for payments of Rs 75,000 and above.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said the government had earlier claimed on August 6 that "no decision has been taken on MDR" and on August 10 the FM said in Parliament that 'no MDR framework has yet been finalised', but on September 14 a notification was issued and within 24 hrs MDR charges were introduced.

'Cong should stop politics over tragedies'

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 15

The Punjab Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Tuesday slammed the Congress, accusing it of exploiting "tragedies" for political gains while refusing to answer questions about its own record.

Punjab has not forgotten the "1984 Sikh massacre", the pain of which continues to be carried by families across generations, and questioned why

Congress leaders still avoid accountability on the issue, it said.

The ruling party lashed out at the Opposition Congress after it held a protest against Finance minister Harpal Singh Cheema, demanding his removal over the alleged suicide of a Dalit man in Sangrur.

Gulzar Singh, who hailed from Dirba in Sangrur district, died on September 7 after allegedly consuming poison. His family alleged that he was

harassed and subjected to casteist slurs for questioning Cheema about the supply of drugs in his area at an event in Dirba.

Punjab Vidhan Sabha Leader of Opposition Par-tap Singh Bajwa on Tuesday also joined the Congress leaders and workers in a protest in Chandigarh demanding the immediate arrest of Cheema and a fair, independent investigation into the death of Gulzar Singh of Toor Banzara village in Sangrur.

Youth call: Gen Z enters Rajasthan's local govt

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Jaipur, September 15

The result of the urban local body polls in Rajasthan pointed to a notable, though limited, entry of Gen Z candidates into the state's local government.

Among them is 21-year-old Neha Sharma, a journalist who decided to jump into the unforgiving waters of electoral politics and emerged victorious in the Thanagazi ward in Rajasthan's Alwar district in the recently held elections.

In the Jaipur Municipal Corporation elections, 18 Gen Z candidates were fielded by the BJP and Congress in the 150 wards that went to polls. Six of them - four from the Congress and two from the BJP - won, meaning Gen Z councillors will account for around four per cent of the Jaipur civic body.

The Congress fielded twice as many Gen Z candidates as the BJP, with 12 candidates compared to

the BJP's six.

Among the youngest Gen Z winners in Jaipur is 21-year-old Congress candidate Faiz Hasan from Ward 71, who defeated 39-year-old Independent candidate Mohammad Salim.

BJP's Palak Yadav, also 21, won Ward 10, defeating 39-year-old Congress candidate Vandana Jakhar. Another closely watched contest was in Ward 115, where 29-year-old BJP candidate Suraj Godiwal defeated 67-year-old Congress candidate Suresh Biwal by 1,063 votes. The result marked a generational contrast, with Godiwal being 38 years younger than his rival.

Sharma, after being elected councillor from Alwar, said her experience of reporting from the state's rural areas motivated her to enter politics and work directly for people. "Kyun na shuruwaat khud se hi ki jaaye? (Why not start with myself?)" she said.

Maratha quota stir: Defiant Jarange leaves for Mumbai

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Jalna, September 15

Undeterred by the police's denial of permission to stage a protest in Mumbai, fasting Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange left for the Maharashtra capital on Tuesday morning from Antarwali Sarati village in Jalna district.

Mumbai Police earlier denied permission to Jarange, who has been on a hunger strike for the last 17 days demanding OBC quota for Maratha community members with Kunbi caste genealogies, to take the protest to Azad Maidan, citing law and order concerns during the ongoing Ganesh festival.

Though defiant, Jarange tweaked his earlier plan to mobilise Maratha community members to Mumbai and decided to go with a select group of 5-10 associates amid tight security.

Bring UCC Bill in Parliament if you have numbers: CM Omar to BJP

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Srinagar, September 15

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday said the BJP should introduce the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill in Parliament if it has the numbers to pass it, instead of pushing it through individual states.

"If you have the numbers, bring it to Parliament. Why are you doing it through different states? Anyway, within their own NDA, not everyone agrees with this. According to the news, Janata Dal (United) raised their hands and said this won't be implemented in Bihar," Abdullah told reporters here.

Abdullah said the BJP should not bring the UCC "through the backdoor".

"The way their own allies are not in favour of it, I don't think they will be able to get it passed in Parliament. That is perhaps why they are taking this route," he added.

ABDULLAH SAID THE BJP SHOULD NOT BRING THE UCC 'THROUGH THE BACKDOOR'

Abdullah said the UCC would not be "universal" if implemented only in states ruled by the BJP, as the party does not govern all the states in the country.

"The whole country is not a BJP-ruled state. There are a number of states and territories that the BJP does not rule. Therefore, if you apply it only to BJP states, it is not a universal [law]. And something that is of this nature should not be decided by individual states; it has to be decided by the country as a whole. The country as a whole is represented not in the states, but in Parliament," he said.

The chief minister said the BJP had not brought some of the key legislations it had been "going to town"

about in Parliament.

"Up until now, whatever legislation they spoke about -- whether it was 'One Nation, One Election' or reservation -- they did not bring those to Parliament. Now, for this one as well, they are talking about bringing it through the states," he said.

On the de-escalation along the Line of Actual Control (LAC), Abdullah said it was a welcome step.

"Anything that reduces tension on the Line of Control or the Line of Actual Control is a good step. Particularly for those people who live close to it, and we know how difficult it is for people living near the LoC or LAC. Similarly, we hope, over time, that along the Line of Control also, things will get better," he said.

On China hailing India's foreign policy, Abdullah said New Delhi's foreign policy had always been independent and there was no need to seek validation from other countries.

Sanjay Nishad's meet with SP leader: Political speculation rife

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 15

Uttar Pradesh Cabinet minister and Nishad Party president Sanjay Nishad's meeting with Leader of Opposition Mata Prasad Pandey has triggered political speculation in the state, months ahead of the Assembly elections.

Nishad visited Pandey's residence in Lucknow on Monday evening and presented him with a bouquet.

He later posted photographs of the meeting on social media, describing it as a "courtesy meeting" during which they discussed various issues.

But Nishad's remarks after the meeting added a political edge to the visit.

"Samajwadi Party shut its door on us, so we went with the BJP. If the BJP also shuts its door, we will consider other options. We will remain with whoever resolves the issues of the Nishad community," Nishad said.

Nishad, however, said the immediate reason for meeting Pandey was to enquire about his health. He said they also discussed the long-standing demand for reservation for the Nishad community under the Scheduled Caste category.

The two leaders also discussed the recent killing of Vinod Sahani in Gonda. Nishad said Pandey told him that he had proved that he was fighting for the Nishad community.

Nishad said he told Pandey that the Gonda incident could have been avoided if the Nishad community had been included in the Scheduled Caste category, arguing that people would then have feared the provisions of the SC/ST Act.

ASKS TO PARTICIPATE IN 'SEVA SANKALP ABHIYAN'

Chhattisgarh CM urges citizens to support local artisans

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Raipur, September 15

For Meera, who sells earthen diyas from a small roadside stall at Telibandha Marine Drive in Raipur on Tuesday turned into a memorable day. As she arranged diyas at her stall, Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai's convoy unexpectedly stopped nearby.

The Chief Minister looked at the earthen diyas displayed at Meera's stall and purchased one for the 'Aashirwad Ka Diya' programme being organised under the 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'. He also gave her Rs 1,000 as a gesture of



appreciation for her hard work and self-reliance.

The Chief Minister said that street vendors, potters, artisans and local producers represent the

strength of a self-reliant Chhattisgarh. Supporting such people means recognising the value of their skills and helping sustain their livelihoods.

KEY POINTS

- » The Chief Minister looked at the earthen diyas displayed at Meera's stall and purchased one for the 'Aashirwad Ka Diya' programme being organised under the 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'
- » The Chief Minister's spontaneous visit came as a pleasant surprise to people present at the Marine Drive

The Chief Minister's spontaneous visit came as a pleasant surprise to people present at the Marine Drive. Without any formalities, he interacted with

Meera and enquired about her work and family.

During the conversation, Chief Minister Sai asked whether she was receiving the benefits of Central and state government welfare schemes. Meera informed him that she had opened a bank account under the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana and was receiving Rs 1,000 every month under the state government's Mahatari Vandan Yojana.

The CM expressed satisfaction that the benefits of these schemes were reaching her.

He said government welfare programmes

become meaningful when their benefits reach eligible beneficiaries directly and help improve their lives. Ensuring transparent and hassle-free delivery of welfare benefits remains a priority of the government.

Sai said that under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana has brought millions of poor and vulnerable families into the formal banking system and strengthened financial inclusion. Direct transfer of benefits into bank accounts has also made delivery of various welfare schemes more efficient.

HISTORIC STEP TOWARDS RESOLVING WATER DISPUTES: SHAH Kishau Dam: Six northern states sign pact for Rs 15,624-cr project

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 15

Six northern states on Tuesday signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) for the implementation of the long-pending 422-MW Kishau Multipurpose Project in Himachal Pradesh, with Union Home Minister Amit Shah describing the agreement as a “historic” step towards resolving water-related disputes.

The agreement was signed by Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil and the chief ministers of Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Delhi and Rajasthan -- Sukhvir Singh Sukhu, Nayab Singh Saini, Pushkar Singh Dhami, Yogi Adityanath, Rekha Gupta and Bhajanlal Sharma -- in the presence of Shah.

The project, estimated to cost Rs 15,624 crore, envisages a 232.6-metre-high concrete gravity dam on the Tons River along the Uttarakhand-Himachal Pradesh border. It will have a storage capacity of 1,562 million cubic metres, irrigate around 97,000 hectares and generate 1,476 million units of clean hydropower.

Shah said the project would benefit all six states in different ways, with Delhi emerging as the biggest beneficiary. He said the Centre and the six Yamuna basin states were committed to completing the project at the earliest.

The agreement follows



Union ministers Amit Shah and C R Patil, CMs of Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, UP, Rajasthan, Delhi and Haryana, and others during the signing of Kishau Project agreement

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The project, estimated to cost Rs 15,624 crore, envisages a 232.6-metre-high concrete gravity dam on the Tons River along the Uttarakhand-Himachal Pradesh border
- » It will have a storage capacity of 1,562 million cubic metres, irrigate around 97,000 hectares and generate 1,476 million units of clean hydropower

an understanding reached by the states in June to move ahead with the MoU, paving the way for the project to be placed before the Union Cabinet. The project had remained stalled for more than eight years due to differences over financial responsibilities.

Shah said the Centre would bear approximately 90 per cent of the project's financial burden, while the remaining 10 per cent would be borne by

the participating states in accordance with the 1994 agreement.

He said the project was the 10th water dispute to be resolved since Narendra Modi became prime minister. He credited the Ministry of Jal Shakti and the participating states for resolving differences after taking into account technical and economic considerations and safeguarding the interests of all stakeholders.

Himachal Pradesh Chief

Minister Sukhu said his government had consistently worked to protect the state's interests in the project and played a key role in breaking the prolonged deadlock over the sharing of the financial burden.

He said a high-level meeting chaired by Shah on June 16 had resulted in an in-principle decision that the estimated Rs 2,000-crore cost of the power component on Himachal Pradesh's side would be borne by Delhi, Rajasthan and Haryana, which are beneficiaries of the project's water component.

Sukhu said the previous BJP government had agreed to contribute Rs 800 crore towards the state's share, but his government rejected the proposal in view of Himachal Pradesh's limited resources.

Gati Shakti push: Guj gets 4 new GCTs

Railway minister Vaishnaw flags off India's first salt container train

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 15

Railway minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Tuesday highlighted the Centre's Gati Shakti initiative to integrate railways with highways, waterways and other transport modes as he dedicated four Gati Shakti Cargo Terminals (GCTs) in Gujarat and laid the foundation stone for another.

Vaishnaw said 150 Gati Shakti Cargo Terminals had been built and made operational across the country, benefiting different regions. The policy, introduced in 2021, has made connecting cargo facilities with the railway network simpler, he said.

The minister dedicated GCTs at Bhimasar in Kutch, Devaliya in Junagadh, Chandisar in Banaskantha and Shivilakha in Kutch through video conference. He also laid the foundation stone for



A view of a specially designed salt container train

a GCT at Linch in Mehsana.

“The Prime Minister has always emphasised connecting the railways with all other modes,” Vaishnaw said, underlining the need to link highways, railways and waterways to improve transportation.

He also flagged off India's first salt container train, which will operate between Shivilakha in Kutch and Mithapur in Gujarat. The train will use specially designed stainless steel containers to address transportation challenges associated

with salt.

Vaishnaw said salt transported in conventional railway wagons often absorbed moisture and became wet by the time it reached its destination. The wagons could also weigh more than the salt being transported, while loading, unloading and handling posed additional challenges.

The new stainless steel containers have been designed for loading from the top and unloading from the side by tilting the container. Their use would also

provide a better balance between the weight of the salt and the container, he said.

The minister said the new cargo terminals and salt containers reflected efforts to improve the efficiency of freight movement through better infrastructure and multimodal connectivity.

Vaishnaw also mentioned railway development works in Kutch. On the occasion, Gopalpur Railway Station was inaugurated in the presence of Gujarat Minister of State Trikam Chhanga and others.

The new station is expected to strengthen rail connectivity and passenger facilities in the region. An operational benefit will be that trains travelling to and from Ahmedabad and Bhuj will no longer require engine reversal at Gandhidham, saving operational time and making train operations smoother.

Job aspirants march in Patna seeking cancellation of exams

MPOST BUREAU

Patna, September 15

Government job aspirants staged a protest march in Patna on Tuesday, demanding cancellation of several recruitment examinations, including those for 1,799 sub-inspector posts, alleging irregularities.

The protesters marched from Gandhi Maidan towards the chief minister's residence but were stopped by police at JP Golambar. Amid rain, some protesters carrying the



Job aspirants during a protest march in Patna

Tricolour breached barricades and took alternative routes. Some also attempted to block rail-

way tracks, while others moved towards the Assembly and the chief minister's residence.

Patna SSP Kartikeya K Sharma said several protesters were detained after entering prohibited areas, disrupting public order and essential services, he said.

The protesters sought cancellation of the 70th BPSC examination and the BPSSC recruitment exam, besides an end to the contract system and the 25 per cent weightage rule.

Couple found dead 1.5 km apart tied to trees in Bijnor

MPOST BUREAU

Bijnor, September 15

The bodies of a couple were found in separate locations here on Tuesday, tied to trees, with the woman in a semi-naked condition and the man wearing her salwar, police said.

The deceased, residents of Jalalpur Kazi village under Bijnor Kotwali police station, had gone to collect wood to a canal area on Monday, Additional Superintendent of Police Krishna Gopal Singh said.

Family members went looking for them but could not find them. Blood stains were found at the spot, following which police were informed, the ASP said.

Police conducted an extensive search of the area, including with the help of a drone, but could not trace the couple on Monday.

On Tuesday morning, the 36-year-old woman's body was found tied with her dupatta to a tree, the police said. Her body was found in a semi-nude condition.

The 40-year-old man's body was found around 1.5 km away, also tied to a tree with the clutch wire of a motorcycle. He was wearing his wife's salwar, the police said. Police teams have been formed to identify and trace those allegedly involved in the incident, the ASP said.

The bodies have been sent for postmortem examination and further investigation is underway, police said.

Briefs

ED to boost strength by 60%

NEW DELHI: The ED will increase its sanctioned strength by 60 per cent to 3,256 posts under a new cadre structure from January 1, 2027. The decision was taken at the Quarterly Conference of Zonal Officers at IIM Bangalore on September 14-15. The ED also aims to cut investigation time to 18 months.

CISF, IIT Kanpur ink two pacts

NEW DELHI: The CISF signed two MoUs with IIT Kanpur on Tuesday to strengthen cybersecurity, and drone and anti-drone capabilities. The agreements provide for a six-week cybersecurity training programme for CISF personnel and a Centre of Excellence on drone technology at the force's Behror facility.

CBI arrests 2 RDSO officials

NEW DELHI: The CBI arrested four people, including two RDSO officials, in a bribery case involving a private firm. The accused were allegedly caught accepting Rs 4 lakh bribe in Howrah. The agency seized Rs 4.73 lakh during searches in Kolkata, Lucknow and Bihar.

Hry CM calls for closer monitoring of schemes

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 15

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday reviewed the functioning of Chief Minister's Good Governance Associates (CMGGAs) and directed them to strengthen governance at the grassroots, ensure transparency and monitor delivery of government schemes.

At a meeting at Haryana Bhawan in New Delhi, Saini asked CMGGAs to closely monitor implementation of schemes in their respective districts and regularly submit evaluation reports to the Chief Minister's Office.

He directed them to prepare detailed reports on the status of Chief Minister's announcements, identifying pending projects and reasons for delays. Reports should also cover the ground-level implementation of the Nirogi Haryana scheme and the functioning of Samadhan Shivirs at district and sub-



divisional levels.

Saini asked the associates to conduct surprise inspections of the camps and submit factual reports. They were also directed to assess the status of sports stadiums and Vyayamshalas across the state and participate in monthly district-level meetings on development works.

The CM reviewed the e-Registry portal and directed that a departmental meeting be convened to address shortcomings highlighted by the CMGGAs. He also sought reports on infrastructure deficiencies in industrial areas and asked the associates to focus on parameters covered under the NITI Aayog's Aspirational Districts Programme.

Mann says Canal water reaches 80% of Punjab agricultural fields

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 15

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday said the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government was focused on the welfare of the people, while the Congress, BJP and Shiromani Akali Dal were engaged in a struggle for political power.

Addressing a Lok Milni programme at Jindwari village in Sri Anandpur Sahib, Mann said canal water had reached 80 per cent of the state's agricultural fields, compared with 26 per cent when his government assumed office. He said the government aimed to take canal irrigation coverage to 100 per cent.

Mann urged Punjabis to stay away from the BJP and Akali Dal, alleging that both parties had worked against the interests of the state. He cited issues including Chandigarh, Panjab University, the Bhakra Beas Management Board, the Sutlej Yamuna Link canal, Harike



Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann addresses a Lok Milni event at Jindwari

canal and central funds for rural development and border areas.

He said the AAP government had laid a 14,000-km pipeline network to carry canal water to fields, while more than 90 per cent of households were receiving free electricity. The government, he said, had also provided jobs to more than 70,000 youth on merit and was improving education, healthcare, roads and other infrastructure.

The chief minister accused the Akali leader-

ship of patronising drug trade and mafias and alleged that it had failed to protect the interests of Punjab. He also criticised Akali leader Sukhbir Singh Badal, questioning his understanding of the state's basic issues.

Mann said the government was spending taxpayers' money on development and claimed that 45,000 km of roads were being renovated or upgraded. He said 3,100 sports stadiums were being constructed to help divert youth from drugs.

MP Cabinet clears development proposals worth Rs 42,490 crore

Samagra Shiksha gets Rs 36K-cr for 5-year continuation; Irrigation, transport, horticulture & welfare schemes approved

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

Bhopal, September 15

The Madhya Pradesh Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, on Tuesday approved proposals worth more than Rs 42,490 crore aimed at strengthening infrastructure, expanding public services and accelerating welfare and development initiatives across the state.

The Cabinet approved Rs 36,006.22 crore for continuation of the Centre-sponsored Samagra Shiksha scheme from 2026-27 to 2030-31. The scheme covers students from pre-primary to Class 12 and focuses



on improving learning outcomes, access, equity and inclusion, vocational education and teacher training.

To strengthen transport infrastructure and citizen services, the Cabinet approved Rs 1,166.60 crore for continuation of 11 Trans-

port Department schemes for five years. The largest allocations include Rs 377.41 crore for flying squads and checkposts, Rs 361.89 crore for district establishments and Rs 245.55 crore for continuation of the smart card scheme. Funds were also

KEY POINTS
» Rs 2,600 crore-plus cleared for three irrigation projects, targeting irrigation capacity over 1.27 lakh hectares
» Rs 1,166.60 crore sanctioned for 11 Transport Department schemes and Rs 491 crore for eight horticulture schemes
» Rs 2,220.62 crore interest-free loan approved for MARK-FED; Cabinet also ratified Rs 250 additional Raksha Bandhan assistance for Ladli Behna beneficiaries.

approved for driving training centres, rural transport and road safety initiatives.

The Cabinet also cleared Rs 491 crore for eight horticulture and food-processing schemes for 2026-27 to 2030-31, aimed at increasing farmers' incomes and

expanding horticultural production. Fruit plantation and spice-area expansion schemes will receive Rs 100 crore each, while Rs 85 crore has been earmarked for protected cultivation.

In the irrigation sector, projects worth over Rs

2,600 crore were approved. The Chitawad project in Ujjain received Rs 1,846.05 crore and is expected to create irrigation facilities over 65,000 hectares. The Gaund major irrigation project in Singrauli was sanctioned Rs 749.62 crore for developing irrigation capacity over 34,500 hectares, while Rs 11.49 crore was approved for the Chanderi micro-irrigation project in Ashoknagar, targeting 28,000 hectares.

The Cabinet approved 21 new posts for mineral branches in newly formed districts of Maihar, Mauganj and Pandhurna. Another 36 regular posts were sanctioned for four upgraded

high schools in Anuppur and Shahdol.

It also ratified the decision to provide an additional Rs 250 special assistance to beneficiaries of the Ladli Behna scheme on Raksha Bandhan.

In another major decision, the Cabinet approved an interest-free loan of Rs 2,220.62 crore to MARK-FED to facilitate repayment of its outstanding food-grain credit-limit loan by September 30, 2026. The Cabinet was also apprised of decisions taken at the 64th meeting of the Madhya Pradesh Rural Road Development Authority's empowered committee held on May 26.

EDITORIAL

Beyond the ₹2,000 Threshold

India's decision to guarantee zero charges on UPI transactions only up to ₹2,000 marks a subtle but significant change in the philosophy governing its digital payments revolution. The immediate reassurance is important: consumers have not been asked to pay ₹5, or any other fee, simply because they make a UPI payment exceeding ₹2,000. Person-to-person transfers also remain outside the emerging debate over merchant charges. What has changed is the legal architecture. Parliament has removed the earlier blanket statutory prohibition on charges for UPI and RuPay debit-card payments, while the government has specifically protected transactions up to ₹2,000. This creates room for a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) to eventually be introduced on higher-value merchant transactions. The distinction may appear technical, but it could shape the next phase of a payments system that has transformed everyday commerce in India.

There is a reasonable case for revisiting the economics of UPI. Digital payments may appear virtually costless to a customer scanning a QR code, but the network supporting that transaction is anything but free. Banks, payment companies and technology providers must maintain servers, settlement systems, cybersecurity infrastructure, fraud-control mechanisms, dispute-resolution processes and customer support while processing transactions on an extraordinary scale. UPI recorded more than 24,000 crore transactions worth over ₹314 lakh crore in 2025-26, illustrating both its spectacular success and the enormous infrastructure required to sustain it. The zero-MDR regime was invaluable when India needed to persuade merchants and consumers to move away from cash and embrace digital payments. It helped turn the QR code into one of the most recognisable features of Indian commerce. But infrastructure at this scale requires a sustainable financing model. Asking large commercial establishments to contribute modestly towards the cost of operating the system is not inherently unreasonable, particularly when digital payments reduce cash-handling costs and improve efficiency.

The government must, however, recognise precisely why UPI became ubiquitous. Its greatest competitive advantage was not merely speed or convenience but the absence of friction. A street vendor, neighbourhood shop and large retailer could accept essentially the same payment method without customers having to calculate an additional charge. That simplicity changed behaviour and made cashless payments ordinary even for purchases worth only a few rupees. Even if a future MDR is formally imposed only on merchants, however, the economic burden does not necessarily remain with them. Large businesses may absorb a small fee as a cost of doing business, but merchants operating on thinner margins could increase prices, encourage alternative payment methods or find ways to pass the charge on. The ₹2,000 threshold therefore requires careful implementation. Only a relatively small proportion of merchant UPI transactions may cross this level by volume, but higher-value transactions account for a substantial share of the money moving through the network. That makes them an attractive revenue source while creating the danger that charges introduced narrowly today could gradually become normalised across a wider range of transactions tomorrow.

India therefore needs a calibrated model rather than a simple return to transaction fees. Small merchants and ordinary consumers must remain protected, while any MDR eventually imposed on large merchants should be modest, transparent and preferably capped instead of rising mechanically with transaction value. Merchant classification will matter too. A ₹2,100 transaction at a small independent business cannot necessarily be treated economically in the same manner as a ₹20,000 purchase from a large retail chain. Policymakers must ensure that the pursuit of sustainability does not penalise precisely the smaller businesses that UPI helped bring into the formal digital economy. Most importantly, regulators must prevent explicit or disguised UPI surcharges from reaching consumers.

UPI has become more than another payment option. It is effectively a piece of national digital infrastructure because hundreds of millions of Indians have stopped thinking about the mechanics or cost of using it. Finding a sustainable mechanism to finance the banks and technology systems supporting UPI is legitimate as the network expands. But the solution must preserve the feature that made the system extraordinary in the first place: effortless payments without anxiety over additional costs. India can ask large businesses to contribute towards maintaining its digital payments infrastructure without allowing charges to creep downwards towards everyday consumers and small merchants. Turning every QR scan into a fee calculation would risk undoing part of what made UPI such a remarkable success.

Wisdom to See What Power Cannot

Through Tara, the Ramayana reveals that true wisdom lies in questioning assumptions, speaking uncomfortable truths and remaining responsible when counsel is rejected

BHARAT KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON, BHARAT KI SOCH

Wisdom is often recognised too late. In the moment, confidence can appear more convincing than caution, action more attractive than reflection, and strength more reassuring than doubt. Yet some of the most consequential decisions are shaped not by what we know, but by whether we are willing to reconsider what we think we know. Tara's story in the Ramayana unfolds around precisely this challenge. She notices what others overlook, questions what others assume, and has the courage to speak when silence would have been easier. Her significance lies not merely in giving good advice, but in showing how intelligence becomes meaningful when it is placed in the service of responsibility.

Tara, queen of Kishkindha, strategist and mother of Angada, emerges in the Ramayana as one of its most perceptive voices of judgement. The conflict between Vali, popularly known as Bali, and his younger brother Sugriva is central to the Kishkindha Kanda. After being driven from the kingdom, Sugriva encounters Rama and Lakshmana and forms an alliance with them.

When Sugriva returns and once again challenges Vali, Tara immediately senses that something is different. Sugriva had recently suffered defeat. His rapid return and renewed confidence represent a critical anomaly. Rather than rely on apprehension, Tara asks what new factor has entered the situation and recognises the significance of Sugriva's alliance with Rama. She warns Vali against rushing into battle and also points towards another path, one based on reconciliation rather than allowing the conflict to deepen. Vali refuses. Convinced of his strength, he goes out to fight. Tara's apprehension proves justified.

The first lesson from Tara's story is therefore important in life as well as leadership: good judgement begins with evidence, especially when familiar circumstances suddenly behave in unfamiliar ways. Tara does not simply look at Sugriva. She looks at the situation surrounding him. His behaviour is inconsistent with what had happened before,

and she treats that inconsistency as information.

This ability is indispensable in organisations. A dominant company may underestimate a smaller competitor because it defeated similar challengers in the past. A strategy that delivered results for years may continue unquestioned even after technology, consumer expectations or regulatory conditions have changed. Strong institutions therefore need systems that regularly test assumptions rather than allowing past success to become the final word.

The same discipline matters in everyday life. In an age of instant reactions, viral claims and social media certainty, Tara offers the opposite instinct: pause, examine the evidence and be willing to reconsider an earlier assumption. Good judgement is not stubborn consistency. It is the ability to revise a conclusion when the facts change.

Vali's response reveals a second lesson. His confidence is not entirely irrational. He is immensely powerful and has defeated Sugriva before. The problem arises when confidence in his own ability becomes a substitute for understanding the situation around him. Tara evaluates the changing circumstances. Vali evaluates his own strength.

Do not confuse confidence with correctness. Experience and a record of success can understandably create confidence, but they can also make contrary information easier to dismiss. In corporate life, the question before a major decision cannot only be, "Are we capable of doing this?" It must also be, "What do we know, what might we not know, and what assumptions are we making?"

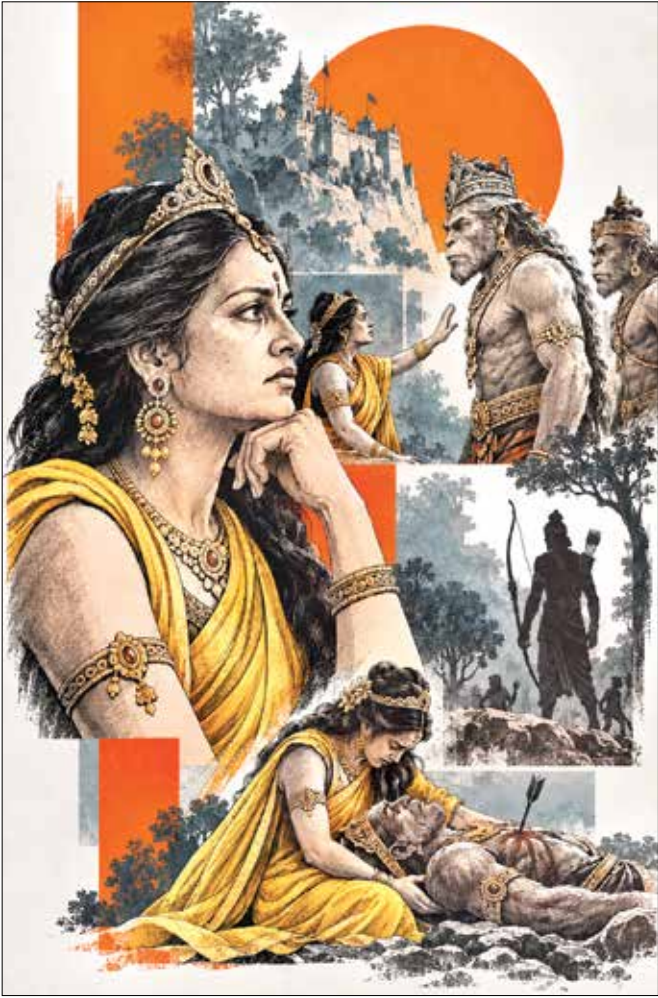
This is why robust organisations create processes for risk assessment, independent review and alternative perspectives, ensuring that inconvenient information and emerging risks can reach the decision-making table before action becomes irreversible. Tara's reasoning demonstrates strategic problem-solving: identify the anomaly, investigate the changed circumstances, assess the risk and consider an alternative course.

It also reminds us that wisdom should be recognised on the strength of insight, not restricted by gender, age, designation or formal authority. The quality of an idea does not depend on the hierarchy of the person expressing it.

Tara's warning to Vali also demonstrates something more demanding than loyalty. It demonstrates moral courage.

Moral courage means speaking an inconvenient truth respectfully when silence would be easier and personally safer. Tara understands Vali's strength and position, yet she does not allow these to prevent her from saying what she believes he needs to hear.

In institutions, a colleague who identifies a weakness, questions an assumption or draws attention to an overlooked risk may show greater



Tara reminds modern leaders that confidence must never replace judgement

FROM FORESIGHT TO DIPLOMACY, TARA SHOWS WHAT RESPONSIBLE LEADERSHIP LOOKS LIKE IN TIMES OF CRISIS

commitment than someone who simply reinforces the prevailing view. The lesson also extends to younger people. Moral courage may mean resisting peer pressure, questioning unethical conduct, warning a friend, or disagreeing respectfully with someone senior.

Yet Tara does not stop at warning Vali against confrontation. She urges him to set aside hostility towards Sugriva and consider reconciliation. Her counsel therefore does more than identify a danger. It points towards a way out of it.

Tara's story becomes even more compelling after her advice fails to change Vali's decision. Vali goes into battle and is struck by Rama's arrow. Tara's grief at his fall is profound. She had foreseen the danger and tried to prevent it, but foresight offers little comfort once the loss has occurred.

This is important because resilience should not be confused with emotional detachment. Tara is not untouched by what happens. She mourns deeply. Her resilience lies in passing through sorrow without allowing sorrow to permanently release her from responsibility.

Responsible leadership does not merely manage the present crisis. It asks what kind of environment those who come next will inherit.

Tara's wisdom appears again when another crisis approaches Kishkindha. After Sugriva becomes king, the rainy season passes while Rama continues to wait for the promised assistance in finding Sita. Lakshmana arrives in anger, believing that Sugriva has neglected his commitment.

Tara's diplomacy is more sophisticated than simply calming an angry person. She recognises that Lakshmana's grievance is legitimate. Rather than denying it, she acknowledges the emotion, provides context and redirects attention towards the shared objective that still unites Rama and Sugriva. Effective diplomacy therefore requires both truth and timing.

The corporate parallel is immediate. A commitment may have been missed, a partner may feel let down, or two parts of an organisation may blame each other for failure. The instinctive response is often defensiveness, which usually intensifies the conflict. Tara's method offers a useful framework for crisis communication: acknowledge the concern, communicate the relevant facts and return attention to the objective both sides still share. De-escalation becomes an act of leadership when it protects relationships without ignoring accountability.

There is also a broader moral lesson in Tara's journey. She experiences circumstances she did not choose, decisions she could not control and loss she could not prevent. Yet she does not permit these experiences to destroy her capacity for judgement.

Her relevance therefore extends far beyond kinship or corporate leadership. For the modern generation, Tara offers a discipline for everyday life: examine changed circumstances, test assumptions, speak with moral courage, disagree constructively and remain responsible when outcomes do not go as hoped.

In workplaces and public life, character is often revealed by whether we can disagree without disrespect, grieve without becoming bitter, and rebuild without becoming consumed by vindication. Tara also reminds us that wisdom remains incomplete unless it serves others. She does not use insight to establish superiority. She uses it to prevent harm, preserve relationships and restore order.

That transformation of intelligence into responsibility is perhaps her greatest lesson. Tara's authority arises from the accuracy of her judgement, the courage with which she expresses it and the responsibility with which she uses it. The value of wisdom is ultimately measured not by how convincingly it proves us right, but by how responsibly it helps us protect what matters.

Views expressed are personal

LETTER



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No Digital Impunity

Meta's decision to report child sexual abuse cases to law enforcement is welcome, but it must mark the beginning rather than the end of stronger accountability. Social media companies cannot remain passive until harmful material is reported by users. They must proactively detect and remove illegal content, cooperate swiftly with authorities and build stronger safeguards for minors. Children's safety online cannot be sacrificed for engagement, growth or platform convenience.

RITIKA SHARMA, GURUGRAM

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002



A question of safety

ANANYA VERMA

The Gurugram hit-and-run involving biker Shivani Chauhan raises concerns extending beyond one collision. Video footage and allegations that the car was deliberately steered towards her have rightly prompted a serious police investigation, while the accused maintains it was an accident. The facts must ultimately be established through evidence and

due process. But one principle is already clear: disagreements on the road can never justify intimidation, aggression or dangerous driving. A vehicle can become lethal within seconds. India's roads will remain unsafe unless restraint replaces rage and motorists recognise that protecting another person's life matters more than asserting dominance.

News at a glance

Bangladesh: Death penalty for 7 Awami League leaders

DHAKA: Bangladesh's International Crimes Tribunal on Tuesday sentenced to death seven senior leaders of the banned Awami League for crimes against humanity over their alleged roles in directing, inciting or facilitating violence during the 2024 student-led protests, dubbed the July Uprising.

The three-member tribunal (ICT-2) headed by Justice Mohammad Nazrul Islam Chowdhury delivered the verdict against the seven, who were tried in absentia.

Bangladesh, Pakistan stress parliamentary diplomacy

DHAKA: Bangladesh and Pakistan have stressed the need to strengthen parliamentary diplomacy through regular dialogue, exchanges of parliamentary delegations and greater people-to-people contacts to deepen bilateral relations, according to a local media report.

The emphasis came during a meeting between Bangladesh Jatiya Sangsad Deputy Speaker and parliamentary delegation leader Barrister Kayser Kamal and Pakistan National Assembly Speaker Sardar Ayaz Sadiq on Monday in Cape Town.



New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani speaks during a public interaction, in New York

AP/PTI

NATO jets down drone in Lithuanian airspace

VILNIUS: NATO fighter jets shot down a drone that entered Lithuanian airspace overnight, officials said Tuesday, less than a day after NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte said that strikes close to the alliance's territory would drive the trans-Atlantic organisation to increase its support for Kyiv.

The drone was downed near the village of Pratkunai in the Kaišiadorys district, about 60 miles (100 kilometres) west of the country's capital, Vilnius, and near the Kaunas Reservoir, Lithuania's National Crisis Management Centre said Tuesday.

Briefs

Election for PoK 'Prez' on September 24

ISLAMABAD: The election for the "President" of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir would be held on September 24, the region's Election Commission announced on Tuesday.

The office of the "president" has remained vacant since January following the death of Barrister Sultan Mahmood Chaudhry. Speaking at a press conference in Muzaffarabad, PoK's Chief Election Commissioner Ghulam Mustafa Mughal said polling would be held at the Assembly Secretariat on September 24.

China backs global AI governance

BEIJING: China on Tuesday called for stronger "global governance" of artificial intelligence, saying all countries should work together to develop the technology for the benefit of humanity and prevent it from "getting out of control".

"We noted recent remarks by some in the US AI industry," Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun said, responding to questions about concerns raised by AI experts over the dangers posed by the rapidly developing technology.

Senate to vote on crypto regulation

WASHINGTON: The Senate is set to vote Tuesday on whether to move forward with legislation to create a new regulatory framework for cryptocurrency, a pivotal election-year test for the \$2.3 trillion market as many Democrats say it doesn't go far enough to rein in President Donald Trump's investments.

The vote, just two months before the midterm elections, comes as the crypto industry has become a major political force and as Trump has amassed significant crypto wealth while in office.

While some Democrats support the idea of a regulatory framework the party has been mostly united in opposition to the legislation.

HUMAN RIGHTS WATCH ACCUSES HOUTHIS OF WAR CRIMES

Saudi airstrikes leave 3 dead: Houthi

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, September 15

A Houthi official said Tuesday that Saudi warplanes struck Yemen, killing three people, including two children, while Human Rights Watch accused the Houthi rebels of possible war crimes with its attacks on commercial vessels.

The renewed fighting in Yemen is endangering civilians and threatening shipping through the Red Sea, a route that has become more important due to disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz since the US and Israel launched joint strikes against Iran on February 28 to spark the war.

The Associated Press couldn't independently verify the Houthi official's claim. The official didn't say what the Saudi warplanes had targeted.

Anees al Asbahi, a spokesperson for the Houthi-run Health Ministry, said in an X post on Tuesday that Saudi airstrikes killed three people, including two children, in Yemen's Taiz province. The Associated Press couldn't independently verify the claim. Al-Asbahi said that two other people were wounded in the strikes.



Yemen's Houthi rebels check their weapons during a mobilization campaign in Sanaa

AP/FILE PHOTO

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The renewed fighting in Yemen is endangering civilians and threatening shipping through the Red Sea
- » The Houthis say their attacks on Saudi-linked shipping are retaliation for the Saudi-led coalition blockade on the Houthi-held areas in Yemen

oil exports.

The Houthis' latest seizures, which follow their capture of the Red Sea port of Mokha and a strategic

additional leverage in the war. New York-based Human Rights Watch said Tuesday that at least three attacks by Houthi rebels against commercial vessels in the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden between July 20 and August 24 could amount to war crimes.

The Houthi attacks against Saudi-linked shipping started in mid-July in the latest flare-up of violence in the Yemen civil war.

Niku Jafarnia, a Yemen and Bahrain researcher at Human Rights Watch, said that irrespective of any politics involved, "attacks on civilian crews carried out deliberately or recklessly are war crimes."

The Houthis say their attacks on Saudi-linked shipping are retaliation for the Saudi-led coalition blockade on the Houthi-held areas in Yemen, a measure related to Yemen's decade-old civil war.

The rights organisation said that the Houthis claimed to have attacked at least nine vessels over the span of a month, including two Saudi-flagged vessels, a Tanzania-flagged vessel and a Dominica-flagged vessel.

Nepal, Indian teams near final stage of Chilime tunnel op

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nuwakot, September 15

Nepal and India's joint rescue teams have reached the final stage of efforts to clear the blocked portion of the Chilime tunnel and reach an underground powerhouse, where six workers are believed to be trapped, authorities said.

The tunnel face is being cleared using wheel loaders.

Once the blocked section is cleared, the Indian and Nepalese rescue teams will move further inside the tunnel to reach and rescue the workers, they said.

Indian Ambassador to Nepal Naveen Srivastava said on Monday that the



joint team had continued work to clear the remaining blocked section of the tunnel using excavators and loaders.

The operation faced unexpected challenges, including an inflow of water from inside the tunnel and the presence of large boulders, he said.

The teams are using mud pumps to remove the water, Srivastava said, adding that the clearing work was expected to continue on Tuesday to reach the powerhouse.

Trump slams SC for rejecting push to restrict mail ballots

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, September 15

President Donald Trump on Tuesday went after the Supreme Court after it rejected his push to restrict mail-in voting in this year's midterms, saying justices who opposed him were "not the people I interviewed".

His social media misfire was just the latest in a long history of Trump assailing justices, particularly those he had nominated, who ruled against him on his administration's most prominent initiatives.

The president has been publicly furious with the Supreme Court over its decisions against restricting birthright citizenship and his ability to issue tariffs unilaterally.

On mail-in voting, the Trump administration had made a last-minute push to have the US Postal Service play a central role in deciding who would be able to receive a ballot.

But state election officials argued there was not enough time to make the changes for the Nov 3 midterm elections – and said their systems were already secure

and accurate.

The court ruled late Monday in an emergency order that the restrictions would most likely lose in court, at least for this year's election.

"The Court's inability and unwillingness to do the right thing for our Country will go down, in a very negative way, in the annals of History," Trump wrote in a lengthy social media post Tuesday.

"This Supreme Court is bullied and cajoled by the Radical Left into making decisions that have set America back at least a hundred years."

US strips millions in military aid from Europe

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, September 15

The Trump administration is stripping tens of millions of dollars in US military assistance to countries in Europe and the Middle East to support conservative-leaning governments in Central and South America.

The State Department on Tuesday notified Congress that it will reprogramme \$52 million in foreign military financing from Slovakia, North Macedonia, Tunisia and Iraq to Panama, Peru, Ecuador and Colombia.

As last US troops pack up in Iraq, militias signal their weapons will stay

In the past, America has sometimes struck militia sites in Iraq in retaliation for attacks

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Baghdad, September 15

Two deadlines are looming for Iraq at the end of the month: the end of a decades-long US military presence and the disarmament of non-state armed groups.

The US withdrawal is underway, and officials say the hundreds of troops remaining in northern Iraq will be out by the Sept. 30 deadline. The Iraqi government has linked the US

withdrawal to an ultimatum for militias to lay down their weapons. But most have indicated they have no plans to do so.

That leaves major questions about what the day after will look like in Iraq.

Iranian-backed Iraqi militias have struck US-linked targets both inside and outside of Iraq since the US and Israel attacked Iran on Feb. 28. They also have coordinated with Yemen's Houthi rebels to attack Saudi Arabia.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Iranian-backed Iraqi militias have struck US-linked targets both inside and outside of Iraq since the US and Israel attacked Iran on February 28
- » US officials are concerned about the militias' ability to continue carrying out attacks — but not enough to delay their withdrawal

With the war between the US and Iran raging, Tehran is unlikely to give up the leverage it has in neighboring Iraq. US

US troops invaded Iraq in 2003 to topple Saddam Hussein. They departed in 2011, but three years later, Iraqi authorities invited a smaller US-led mission to fight the Islamic State group, which had rampaged across Iraq, seizing large swaths of territory.

With the extremist group now reduced to scattered sleeper cells – a result of the intervention of Iran-backed militias as well as the US-led coalition -- Washington and Baghdad

agreed in 2024 to wind the mission down.

US troops pulled out of bases in most areas of Iraq last year but maintained a presence in the semiautonomous northern Kurdish region. Bases there have regularly come under attack since the US and Israel launched their war against Iran.

A US military official said the withdrawal would be completed by Sept. 30, and the hundreds of troops still present in northern

Iraq would mostly be redeployed to Jordan and other countries in the region. Military equipment, including air defense systems, will also be removed. He spoke on condition of anonymity because he was not authorized to comment publicly.

A "normal bilateral security cooperation" agreement could then be negotiated with the central government in Baghdad, he said, but it remains unclear what form that would take.

News at a glance

India-New Zealand trade pact may take effect in late October

NEW DELHI: The India-New Zealand free trade agreement (FTA) is likely to come into force in the latter half of October, with the exact date to be announced, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said on Tuesday.

The countries signed the pact on April 27 to boost trade in goods and services and investment. The agreement provides duty-free access for 100 per cent of India's exports to New Zealand. An official said it is expected to take effect from October 19. New Zealand levies tariffs up to 10 per cent on Indian goods. It has committed to invest \$20 billion in India.

India's August vegetable oil imports decline 4.7 per cent

NEW DELHI: India's vegetable oil imports fell 4.71 per cent to 16.09 lakh tonnes in August from 16.94 lakh tonnes a year earlier, as palm oil shipments declined amid rising global prices & a weaker rupee, the Solvent Extractors' Association said Tuesday.

During November-August of the 2025-26 oil year, imports rose 4 per cent to 138.8 lakh tonnes from 133.37 lakh tonnes. Edible oil imports fell to 15.72 lakh tonnes from 16.88 lakh tonnes. Palm oil imports dropped to 7.60 lakh tonnes from 9.79 lakh tonnes, while soyabean oil rose to 5.54 lakh tonnes from 3.87 lakh tonnes.

Pratt & Whitney, Bharat Forge tie up for DRDO's UAV

MUMBAI: Diversified group Bharat Forge Ltd on Tuesday said it has partnered with Pratt & Whitney Canada to evaluate integrating advanced turboprop engines into a high-altitude, long-endurance (HALE) UAV program designed by India's DRDO.

Pratt & Whitney Canada will assess engine compatibility, performance and installation requirements, while Bharat Forge will lead engine-airframe integration.

The collaboration seeks to advance India's indigenous aerospace and defence capabilities under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative.

Digital lending platform Fibe gets Sebi nod to launch IPO

NEW DELHI: Social Worth Technologies Ltd, which operates under the Fibe brand, has received Sebi's approval to raise Rs 750 crore through a fresh issue, along with an Offer-for-Sale of over 4 crore equity shares by existing shareholders. Proceeds will be invested in subsidiary ESPL.

The Pune-based digital lender offers personal loans & purpose-driven financing for consumption, education, insurance & healthcare. Its AUM grew 45.49 per cent to Rs 8,603 crore as of March 31, 2026, from Rs 4,064 crore in 2024, while profit rose to Rs 257.46 crore from Rs 101.24 crore.

INVESTORS CAN BID FOR A MINIMUM 8 EQUITY SHARES IN A LOT
NSE IPO to open on Sept 17, price band of ₹1,700-₹1,785/equity share

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 15

National Stock Exchange of India Ltd (NSE) has fixed the price band for its IPO at Rs 1,700-Rs 1,785 per equity share of face value Rs 1. The issue will open on September 17, 2026 and close on September 21, 2026. Investors can bid for a minimum of 8 shares and in multiples of 8 thereafter.

NSE has 2,475,000,000 equity shares outstanding.

The IPO is an offer-for-sale of up to 126,436,650 shares by State Bank of India, Canada Pension Plan Investment Board, Aranda Investments (Mauritius) Pte Ltd, MS Strategic (Mauritius) Ltd, The New India Assurance Company Ltd, SBI Capital Markets Limited, Bank of Baroda, Stock Holding Corporation of India Limited, General Insurance Corporation of India Limited and United India Insurance Company Limited.

The book-built issue reserves no more than 50 per cent for Qualified Institutional Buyers, not less than 15 per cent for Non-Institutional Investors and not less than 35 per cent for Retail Individual Investors.

NSE, which began operations in 1994, was India's first exchange to implement electronic trading. It



Ashishkumar Chauhan MD & CEO, NSE

'NSE HAS BEEN INDIA'S LARGEST EXCHANGE BY CASH-MARKET AND EQUITY-DERIVATIVES TURNOVER FROM FISCAL 20011 TO FISCAL 2026 AND THE THREE MONTHS ENDED JUNE 30, 2026'

is the world's largest derivatives exchange by trading volume for calendar year 2025, according to FIA, and ranked third globally in equity segment trades in 2025, according to WFE.

According to the Red-seer Report, NSE has been India's largest exchange by cash-market and equity-derivatives turnover from Fiscal 20011 to Fiscal 2026 and the three months ended June 30, 2026.

It was also the largest in exchange-traded currency derivatives from Fiscal 20092 to Fiscal 2026 and the three months ended June 30, 2026. NSE

had global market shares of 11.38 per cent in cash-equity trades and 51.18 per cent in equity-derivative contracts in Fiscal 2026, and 10.68 per cent and 50.22 per cent, respectively, in the three months ended June 30, 2026.

Its Unique Registered Investors grew at a CAGR of 26.23 per cent from 30.87 million as of March 31, 2020 to 132.37 million as of June 30, 2026. Market capitalisation of listed entities grew at a CAGR of 25.89 per cent over the same period.

Total Fund Mobilisation through its platform

KEY POINTS

- » It was also the largest in exchange-traded currency derivatives from Fiscal 20092 to Fiscal 2026 and the three months ended June 30, 2026
- » NSE enabled equity capital mobilisation of over Rs 1.29 trillion and Rs 4.78 trillion in the three months ended June 30, 2026 and Fiscal 2026, respectively
- » Its revenue from operations rose to Rs 4,560 crore in the June 2026 quarter from Rs 4,032 crore a year earlier, while net profit increased to Rs 3,121 crore from Rs 2,811 crore

was Rs 6.19 trillion in the three months ended June 30, 2026 and Rs 20.33 trillion in Fiscal 2026. As of June 30, 2026, NSE had 261.36 million registered investor accounts, 1,328 trading members, 132.37 million Unique Registered Investors and 3,005 listed entities, with market capitalisation of Rs 474.08 trillion.

NSE's market share in Fiscal 2026 and the three months ended June 2026 was 92.99 per cent and 93.05 per cent in cash markets, 99.79 per cent and 99.72 per cent in equity futures, 74.71 per cent and

68.48 per cent in equity options, 99.48 per cent and 100.00 per cent in currency futures, and 100.00 per cent and 100.00 per cent in currency options. Its corporate-bond market share was 85.65 per cent and 81.15 per cent, respectively.

NSE's platform processed an average of 12.46 billion messages daily between April 1, 2024 and June 30, 2026. It processed a peak 21.89 billion order messages on March 24, 2026, when 201.00 million trades were executed. On June 4, 2024, it processed 293.85 million trades in a single day. The platform can process nearly 5 million messages per second with microsecond response time.

NSE enabled equity capital mobilisation of over Rs 1.29 trillion and Rs 4.78 trillion in the three months ended June 30, 2026 and Fiscal 2026, respectively.

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Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Ltd and 19 other institutions are book-running lead managers, while MUFG Intime India Pvt Ltd is the registrar.



India's merchandise exports surged 26.12 per cent to \$43.81 billion in August, driven by a rise in electronics, engineering & petroleum product shipments, while a dip in gold imports helped narrow the trade deficit to a five-month low of \$26.86 billion.

Imports rose by 14.1 per cent year-on-year to \$70.76 billion in August due to growth in sectors such as crude oil, project goods, electronic items, silver, coal and coke. Gold imports fell 57.75 per cent to \$2.3 billion in August.

The growth in exports in August was the highest since June 2022, when shipments had risen 30.12 per cent.

Exports of electronics, engineering and petroleum products rose by 90 per cent, 25 per cent and 63.27 per cent, respectively.

During April-August this fiscal, exports jumped 17.85 per cent year-on-year to \$215.91 billion, and imports climbed 18.21 per cent to \$363 billion.

Merchandise trade deficit during the first five months of this fiscal year widened to \$147.09 billion as compared to \$123.88 billion during April-August 2025-26. In August last year, the deficit was \$27.22 billion. In July, it was \$31.98 billion. The previous low level of trade gap was \$20.67 billion in March.

Briefing the media on the latest trade data, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal said the good momentum of export growth is continuing and is, rather, building up also.

He said higher imports during the first five months of 2026-27 are being propelled by strong domestic economic expansion, rising energy requirements and the critical inputs needed to sustain the rapid growth of the manufacturing sector. It has also pushed the trade deficit.

The major drivers of the trade deficit have been energy items like petroleum, crude and coal, coke and briquettes, and electronic goods. On the exports front, he said a mix of commodities helped push the growth, and that included engineering goods, petroleum products, chemicals and textiles.

"At the same time, major demand has come from the US, EU, BRICS nations and emerging economies. So this also underscores India's expanding global footprint and improves our resilience, diversification and strategic trade integration objectives," he said.

In August, crude oil imports rose 37.28 per cent to about \$16 billion. During April-August 2026-27, crude oil imports rose to \$95.57 billion from \$78.07 billion in the same period last year. Electronic goods imports also increased to \$66.48 billion from \$46.31 billion during April-August FY26.

On the export front, petroleum products' shipment jumped to \$35.31 billion during April-August FY27 from \$25.32 billion in the same period last year.

Electronics & project goods imports grew by 53.27 per cent to \$13 billion, and by 377.71 per cent to \$960.78 million, respectively, in August.

Meanwhile, as per government estimates, services exports stood at \$38.87 billion in August, and imports were at \$21.42 billion.

Hero Motors garners nearly ₹300 cr from anchor investors ahead of IPO

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 15

Auto parts maker Hero Motors Ltd on Tuesday garnered nearly Rs 300 crore from anchor investors ahead of its IPO, which opens for subscription on September 16. The company allotted 3.57 crore equity shares to anchor investors at Rs 84 apiece, according to a circular uploaded on BSE's website.

Institutions that participated in the anchor book include ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company Ltd, 3P India Equity Fund IM, Edelweiss Life Insurance Company Ltd, Societe Generale and ASAS Global Fund Incorporated VCC Sub Fund, among others.

Additionally, shares were allocated to ICICI Prudential MF, Kotak Mahindra MF, JM Financial MF and Bank of India Mutual Fund.

Hero Motors has fixed a price band of Rs 79-84 per equity share for its Rs 1,000-crore IPO, which will remain open for subscription till September 18.

The IPO comprises a fresh issue of equity shares of up to Rs 600 crore and an OFS of shares worth up to Rs 400 crore by promoters.

Domestic PV dispatches surge 36.5% to 4,39,309 units in August

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 15

Domestic passenger vehicle dispatches from companies to dealers rose 36.5 per cent year-on-year to 4,39,309 units in August, industry body SIAM said on Tuesday.

Passenger vehicle dispatches were at 3,21, 901 units in August 2025, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) said in a statement.

Total two-wheeler sales increased 10.5 per cent to

20,34,698 units last month, as against 18,41,954 units in August last year, it added.

Three-wheeler dispatches were up 22.8 per cent in the previous month at 93,764 units as against 76,324 units in the year-ago period, it added.

"Passenger vehicles, three-wheelers and two-wheelers have recorded the highest ever sales of August in 2026. In August 2026, Passenger Vehicles posted sales of 4.39 lakhs units with double digit growth of 36.5

per cent, three-wheelers sales recorded 0.94 lakh units with growth of 22.8 per cent, and two-wheelers sales logged 20.35 lakhs units with growth of 10.5 compared to the same period of last August 2025," said Rajesh Menon, Director General at SIAM.

"India's automobile industry is passing through a robust growth phase," said Menon, adding that the growth in August has been supported by a lower base of previous year.

India ramps up preparations to help exporters comply with European Union's carbon tax

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 15

India has stepped up preparations to help exporters comply with the European Union's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), with the commerce ministry setting up a committee involving key ministries, departments, regulators and industry bodies.

Additional Secretary in the Department of Commerce Darpan Jain said Indian verifiers can access

the EU CBAM registry from September 2026, while mandatory filing of returns by domestic exporters will begin in September 2027.

"Verification process through verifiers has started in September of this year. But the actual returns have to be filed by September of 2027," Jain told reporters.

CBAM is a carbon tax on imports of carbon-intensive goods such as fertiliser, iron and steel, aluminium and cement. The EU levy is based on its

Emissions Trading System price, adjusted for carbon prices paid in exporting countries.

Jain said the government has conducted training and business programmes and engaged with the EU on accreditation of India's national accreditation body and domestic verifiers. Some Indian verifiers have already applied to EU agencies, with accreditation expected soon. Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has also sought EU

recognition of the National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies (NABCB) as an accreditation body for CBAM verifiers.

On the UK's CBAM, effective January 1, 2027, Jain said Britain has recognised NABCB and will accept its certifications.

The UK has also agreed to recognise carbon payments made under India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme, which can be offset against the payments due in Britain.

India, China start discussions on trade concerns
'There will be meetings subsequently also to take discussions forward'

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 15

India and China have started discussions to address bilateral trade concerns, including structural trade imbalances and supply chain issues, with more meetings expected, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said on Tuesday.

He said the September 12 meeting between Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and Chinese counterpart Wang Wentao was an initial discussion to understand

CLOSER LOOK

- » The engagement assumes significance as China is India's second-largest trading partner. Bilateral trade rose 7.9 per cent to \$127.7 billion in 2025-26 from \$118.39 billion in 2024-25
- » India's exports to China grew 36.62% to \$19.47 billion, while imports rose 16% to \$131.62 billion. Consequently, the trade deficit widened to \$99.19 billion from \$85 billion. India received \$2.51 billion FDI from China between April 2000 and March 2026

each other's positions on trade issues.

"There will be meetings subsequently also to take these discussions forward. These discussions are happening after a long gap," Agrawal told reporters.

He said both sides need to address trade concerns, structural imbalances and supply chain issues while building trust.

"On trade, we have

started engaging. Both sides are engaging very positively," he said.

The engagement assumes significance as China is India's second-largest trading partner. Bilateral trade rose 7.9 per cent to \$127.7 billion in 2025-26 from \$118.39 billion in 2024-25.

India's exports to China grew 36.62 per cent to \$19.47 billion, while imports rose 16 per cent to \$131.62 billion. Consequently, the trade deficit widened to \$99.19 billion from \$85 billion.

India also has concerns over Chinese investments amid tighter FDI rules for countries sharing land borders with India. India received \$2.51 billion FDI from China between April 2000 and March 2026.

During April-August 2026-27, exports to China rose to \$9.61 billion from \$6.93 billion, while imports increased to \$65.49 billion from \$51.56 billion.

Engineering goods, electronics, petroleum products, chemicals and iron ore were among key export sectors.

RBI absorbs ₹3.93L cr from banking system through VRRR auction

AGENCIES
Mumbai, September 15

The RBI on Tuesday absorbed Rs 3,93,352 crore via a variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction amid huge surplus liquidity in the banking system.

The central bank received bids worth Rs 3,93,352 crore against a notified amount of Rs 5 lakh crore and accepted all bids at a cut-off and weighted average rate of 5.24 per cent.

The RBI has been conducting VRRR auctions over the past month to absorb excess liquidity and align overnight money market rates with the repo rate. Liquidity surplus stood at around Rs 10.73 lakh crore on September 11.

The central bank has also announced Open Market Operation sales of G-secs worth Rs 1 lakh crore in three tranches. The first tranche of Rs 50,000 crore will be auctioned on September 17, followed by Rs 25,000 crore each on September 21 & September 28.

IT JUMPED 1.87% AND FOCUSED IT CLIMBED 1.49%

Sensex tanks 778 pts, Nifty closes at 5-month low amid surging oil prices

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 15

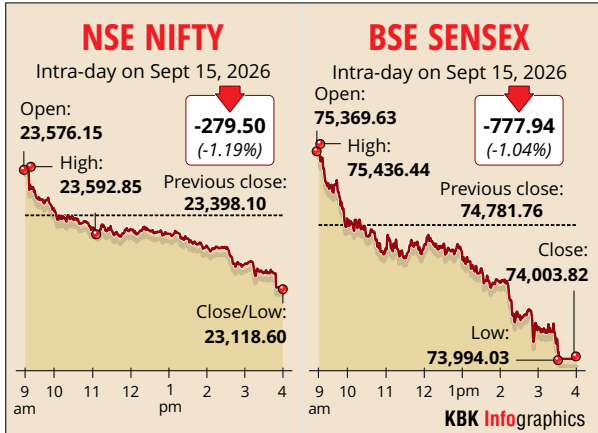
Benchmark Sensex tanked 778 points while the broader stock index Nifty closed at a five-month low on Tuesday amid surging oil prices, geopolitical tensions and weak trends in global markets.

The 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 777.94 points, or 1.04 per cent, to settle at a three-month low of 74,003.82, dragged by losses in blue-chip banking, auto and oil & gas shares.

The index opened higher but lost steam in late-morning deals as selling gathered pace. The barometer later tanked 787.73 points, or 1.05 per cent, to a day's low of 73,994.03.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 279.50 points, or 1.19 per cent, to end at 23,118.60, the lowest closing level since April 6.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Bharat Electronics tumbled 6 per cent. Inter-Globe Aviation, Titan, Bajaj Finserv, Adani Ports,



Mahindra & Mahindra and State Bank of India were also among the laggards.

HCL Tech jumped 3.98 per cent, Infosys climbed 3.64 per cent, Tech Mahindra was up 2.31 per cent, and Tata Consultancy Services (2.18 per cent) and HDFC Bank (1.27 per cent) also rose.

"Domestic markets remained under pressure, extending their recent correction as elevated crude oil prices and rising global bond yields weighed on sentiment. Investors stayed cautious ahead of key central bank meet-

ings this week, with growing expectations of further policy tightening by major economies.

"Concerns about a prolonged high-interest-rate environment, particularly in the US, kept Treasury yields near multi-year highs and continued to dampen emerging market sentiment amid persistent foreign outflows," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, said.

IT stocks outperformed as comments suggesting slower AI development eased concerns over the

KEY POINTS

» Among the 30 Sensex firms, Bharat Electronics, Inter-Globe Aviation, Titan, Bajaj Finserv, Adani Ports, M&M & SBI were among laggards

» The BSE MidCap Select index dived 2.50% and SmallCap Select index tanked 2.41%. A total of 3,292 stocks declined, while 1,190 advanced and 202 remained unchanged on the BSE

rapid disruption of traditional IT services, Nair added.

The BSE MidCap Select index dived 2.50 per cent and SmallCap Select index tanked 2.41 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Capital Goods tanked 4.19 per cent, Realty tumbled 3.93 per cent, followed by Industrials (3.57 per cent), Services (3.03 per cent), Power (2.80 per cent) and Insurance (2.71 per cent).

IT jumped 1.87 per cent and Focused IT climbed 1.49 per cent.

A total of 3,292

stocks declined, while 1,190 advanced and 202 remained unchanged on the BSE.

In Asian markets, South Korea's Kospi, Japan's Nikkei 225 index, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index ended lower.

Markets in Europe were trading in negative territory. US markets ended lower on Monday.

The selling was broad-based, with information technology emerging as the only sector to finish in positive territory, he said, adding that selective buying in large technology exporters suggested that immediate concerns over AI-led disruption had eased, although the gains were insufficient to offset weakness across the rest of the market.

The domestic equity markets were closed on Monday on account of Ganesh Chaturthi.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 930.90 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

AMID GLOBAL UNCERTAINTY

Foreign investors pull ₹5,109 cr from govt bonds in three days

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 15

Foreign portfolio investors (FPI) pulled nearly Rs 5,109.21 crore in the last three days from government securities under the fully accessible route amid dampened sentiments due to global uncertainty.

Under the fully accessible route (FAR), eligible overseas investors are allowed to buy and sell certain government securities without any cap.

According to the Clearing Corporation of India, FPI investment in government securities under FAR stood at Rs 366,806.286 crore as on September 15, as compared to Rs 371,915.496 crore as on September 9.

The investment stood at Rs 371,520.751 crore as on September 10 and Rs 366,791.286 crore as on September 11, data showed.

"We saw notable selling by FPIs in G-Secs under the FAR route. Elevated crude prices, hovering around \$110 amid the worsening US-Iran war situation, coupled with US Treasury yields nearing the 5 per cent mark and persistent pressure on the rupee,



FPI INVESTMENT IN GOVT SECURITIES UNDER FAR STOOD AT RS 366,806.286 CRORE AS ON SEPTEMBER 15, AGAINST RS 371,915.496 CRORE AS ON SEPTEMBER 9

have made Indian sovereign debt relatively less attractive to foreign portfolio investors," said Matprasas Pandey, vice president at Choice Wealth.

Brent crude oil prices in the international market have increased as concerns over global supplies intensified after attacks disrupted Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline and planned talks between Gulf Arab states and Iran were postponed.

Currently, Brent crude oil prices stood at \$107.41 per barrel. Further, the

yield on the benchmark 10-year US Treasury note crossed 5 per cent on Monday for the first time since 2023, as a sharp rise in oil prices intensified selling in government bonds globally.

The breach of the key yield level comes amid a widespread bond market sell-off, fuelled by concerns over persistent inflation and rising government and corporate debt. Higher borrowing costs have also pushed debt servicing expenses in the UK, Germany and other economies to multi-year highs.

Typically, rising interest rates in advanced economies make their financial assets more attractive to global investors, prompting them to withdraw investments from emerging markets. This can trigger capital outflows from emerging-market debt, increase borrowing costs and put pressure on their currencies. The outflows were also triggered by a depreciating rupee. The local currency depreciated 42 paise to close at 95.96 against the US dollar on Tuesday amid elevated Brent crude oil prices and heightened Middle East tensions.

Briefs

Rupee falls 34 paise to 95.88/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 34 paise to close at 95.88 against the US dollar on Tuesday, weighed down by escalating Middle East conflict & soaring Brent crude oil prices, which hit \$108 per barrel.

At the interbank fore market, the rupee opened at 95.84 against the US dollar, then lost ground and closed at 95.88, down 34 paise from its previous close.

HDFC Bank shares end up over 1%

NEW DELHI: Shares of HDFC Bank ended over 1 per cent higher on Tuesday as the company's CEO succession plan moved forward with the lender sending two names for the top post to Reserve Bank.

The bellwether stock rose 1.27 per cent to settle at Rs 717 on the BSE. During the day, it edged higher by 3.14 per cent to Rs 730.30.

At the NSE, the stock ended 1.17 per cent higher at Rs 716.55. Intraday, it climbed 3.17 per cent to Rs 730.75.

Current account deficit more than doubles to \$7 bn in July

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Mumbai, September 15

India's current account deficit (CAD) widened to \$7 billion in July from \$3.2 billion a year ago, mainly due to a higher merchandise trade deficit, according to the RBI data released on Tuesday.

The preliminary data on India's balance of payments (BoP) for July 2026 released by the central bank showed that the merchandise trade deficit rose to \$31.7 billion in July from \$28.2 billion in the same month last year.

Imports increased to \$76.8 billion from \$65.6 billion, while exports rose to \$45.1 billion from \$37.4 billion. On the other hand,

there was improvement in net services surplus, which increased to \$17.6 billion in July from \$16.4 billion in the year-ago month. Services exports stood at \$38.3 billion while imports totalled \$20.6 billion during the month under review.

Net transfers increased to \$13.2 billion in July 2026 from \$12.6 billion, while net income outgo widened to \$6.1 billion from \$4 billion.

The capital account recorded a net inflow of \$27.7 billion in July 2026, sharply higher than \$3.5 billion in the year-ago month.

According to the data, net foreign direct investment inflows rose to \$7.3 billion in July from \$4.5 bil-

lion a year earlier. Net foreign portfolio investment recorded an inflow of \$4.1 billion against an outflow of \$2.5 billion in July 2025.

The overall balance stood at a surplus of \$20.8 billion in July 2026, compared with \$0.3 billion in the year-ago month. For the April-July period of 2026-27, the CAD stood at \$11.2 billion, against \$6.6 billion in the corresponding period of 2025-26. The capital account recorded a net inflow of \$23.9 billion during April-July 2026, against \$11.4 billion a year earlier.

The overall balance was a surplus of \$12.7 billion, up from \$4.8 billion a year earlier.

AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 15

India's overall unemployment rate (UR) among persons aged 15 years and above declined marginally to 5 per cent in August from 5.1 per cent in July, according to Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) data released on Tuesday. The rate stood at 5.1 per cent in August 2025.

Rural UR fell to 4.1 per cent from 4.5 per cent, while urban UR rose marginally to 6.8 per cent from 6.7 per cent. Year-on-year, rural UR declined by 0.2 percentage point from 4.3 per cent. It also recorded its lowest level since January 2026.

Overall male UR declined for the third con-

RURAL UNEMPLOYMENT RATE (UR) FELL TO 4.1 PER CENT FROM 4.5%, WHILE URBAN UR ROSE MARGINALLY TO 6.8% FROM 6.7%

secutive month to 4.9 per cent from 5.4 per cent in May 2026.

Rural male UR fell to 4.3 per cent from 4.6 per cent, while urban male UR rose to 6.1 per cent from 5.9 per cent.

Female UR declined for the second consecutive month to 5.1 per cent from 5.9 per cent in June 2026. Rural female UR fell to 3.9 per cent from 4.3 per cent, while urban female UR

remained broadly stable.

The overall Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) rose to 55.6 per cent in August from 55.4 per cent in July. Rural LFPR increased to 58.2 per cent from 58.0 per cent, while urban LFPR remained at 50.4 per cent.

Year-on-year, overall LFPR increased by 0.6 percentage points from 55 per cent to 55.6 per cent. Rural LFPR rose 1.2 percentage points from 57 per cent to 58.2 per cent, while urban LFPR declined 0.5 percentage points from 50.9 per cent to 50.4 per cent.

Female LFPR rose to 34.8 per cent from 34.4 per cent, with rural LFPR increasing to 39.4 per cent from 38.8 per cent and urban LFPR remain-

ing broadly stable at 25.4 per cent.

Year-on-year, female LFPR rose 1.1 percentage points from 33.7 per cent to 34.8 per cent.

Overall Worker Population Ratio (WPR) increased to 52.8 per cent from 52.5 per cent, while rural WPR rose to 55.8 per cent from 55.4 per cent. Urban WPR remained at 47 per cent.

The monthly estimates are based on 3,70,160 persons surveyed.

The PLFS methodology was modified from January 2025 to provide monthly and quarterly labour force estimates. August 2026 was the seventeenth Monthly Bulletin. Overall female WPR rose to 33 per cent from 32 per cent in August 2025.

Former President of India Ram Nath Kovind to address FICCI-CASCADE's 'MASCRADE 2026'

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 15

FICCI-CASCADE will organise the 12th edition of MASCRADE 2026 (Movement Against Smuggled & Counterfeit Trade) from September 17-18 in New Delhi under the theme 'One World, One Fight: Eliminating Counterfeiting and Smuggling Through Collective Action'.

Former President of India Ram Nath Kovind will deliver the inaugural address. Speakers include

Vivek Chaturvedi, Chairman, CBIC; Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva, Judge, Supreme Court of India; Suryaprakash V Raju, Additional Solicitor General, Supreme Court of India; Dr Rajiv Mani, Secretary, Department of Legal Affairs; Vivek Aggarwal, Secretary, Ministry of Culture & M K Singh, Member (IT & Taxpayer Services), CBIC.

Anil Rajput, Chairman, FICCI CASCADE, said, "Illicit trade is no longer a peripheral concern confined to enforcement or re-

venue leakage. It has evolved into a significant economic, societal and national security challenge," calling for coordinated action by government, enforcement agencies, industry & international partners.

Anant Swarup, Secretary General, FICCI, said, "Addressing illicit trade requires a collaborative and forward-looking approach," with industry playing an active role.

Jyoti Vij, Director General, FICCI, said, "Strong and trusted markets are

fundamental to sustainable economic growth," stressing responsible commerce, consumer awareness and compliance.

The conference will bring together Indian and international enforcement agencies & industry experts.

It will also release the FICCI-CASCADE-KPMG study 'Illicit Trade in India: Economic Impact, Enforcement Challenges and the Path Forward' and host the Anti-Counterfeiting and Anti-Smuggling Awards.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



POWERGRID has brought out a book in Hindi titled 'Akshay Urja ke Vidyut Grid Samanvayan mein HVDC Pranali ki Bhumika' (Role of HVDC Systems in Grid Integration of Renewable Energy). The book was released by Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar, Ministers of State for Home Affairs, during the Hindi Diwas 2026 & 6th Akhil Bharatiya Rajbhasha Sammelan held at Navi Mumbai, in presence of Dr. Yatin-dra Dwivedi, Director (Personnel), POWERGRID.

MPOST BUREAU

Udaipur, September 15

Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL) is highlighting the growing role of young engineering talent in transforming mining & metals operations as India celebrates Engineers' Day. Engineering graduates account for 57.8 per cent of the company's executive workforce, while 76 per cent of young professionals come from core engineering disciplines. Nearly 10 per cent of its leaders are below 35 years, while over

62 per cent of the overall workforce is under 35.

Young engineers are increasingly combining core expertise with emerging technologies, contributing to remote blasting, tele-remote equipment handling, real-time monitoring, operational intelligence platforms, automation and digital control rooms.

Of HZL's 2,685 executives, 1,551 have engineering backgrounds, while women account for 20.5 per cent of executives. The company made 335 campus

hires in FY26.

Amarendu Prakash, CEO & Whole-time Director, HZL, said, "The engineer of today is entering an industry that is fundamentally changing." He added that the company aims to create an environment where young engineers' "curiosity, technical capability & ambition" can drive innovation. It also has over 423 non-executives involved in critical engineering processes. Its workforce has a gender diversity ratio of 26.3 per cent.

NBCC reports 33.19% rise in FY26 consolidated PAT at its 66th AGM

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 15

NBCC (India) Ltd held its 66th Annual General Meeting, chaired by Chairman & Managing Director Dr. K P Mahadevaswamy.

The company reported consolidated revenue of Rs 13,195.89 crore in FY 2025-26, up 7.52 per cent, while consolidated PAT rose 33.19 per cent to Rs 742.45 crore.

Standalone total income stood at Rs 10,055.45 crore as on March 31, 2026. It declared its highest-ever dividend of Rs 270 crore (@100 per cent).

NBCC secured business worth Rs 18,780 crore,



with its consolidated order book at Rs 1,27,820 crore as on March 31, 2026. It declared its highest-ever dividend of Rs 270 crore (@100 per cent).

In Amrapali projects, NBCC is executing 38,000 residential units worth Rs 8,598 crore, with more than 32,550 homes completed.

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
“ HUE & CRY NOTICE.”

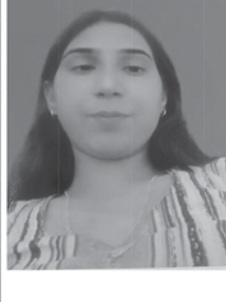
As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/ PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Vishali Sharma D/O Vijay Kumar R/O Bain tehsil & Distt Sambawent missing from samba, but thereafter she did not return home, her search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.23 dated 09.12.2024 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts.

1. PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp@samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Samba:- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:-

Name:	Vishali Sharma	
Parentage	Vijay Kumar	
Permanent Address:	R/O Bain tehsil & Distt Samba	
Age:	20Yrs	
Height:	5 Feet 04 inches	
Complexion	Wheatish	
Face:	Oval	
Body Structure:	Slim	
Language:	Hindi/ Dogri	
Attire	SalwarKameez	

No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated:- .09.2026

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-10517/26

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
“ LOOK OUT NOTICE”

As intimated by SDPO Bari-Brahmana vide letter No. SDPO/BB/26/7925 dated 08.09.2026, that one girl namely Anjali Raikwar D/o Kamlesh Raikwar R/o Chhatarpur MP A/P Trent Morh Bari Brahmana has been missing from Bari-Brahmana and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.20 dated 08.08.2026 of P/S Bari-Brahmana. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing girl may be communicated on following contacts.

1. PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp@samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Bari-Brahmana:- 8713023636

The description roll along with photograph of missing girl is as under:-

Name:	Anjali Raikwar	
D/O	Kamlesh Raikwar	
Permanent Address:	Chhatarpur MP A/P Trent Morh Bari Brahmana	
Age:	19 yrs	
Height:	5 Feet03 Inch	
Complexion	Fair	
Face:	ROUND	
Body Structure:	Medium	
Language:	HINDI	
Attire:	Salwar Kameez	

No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated:- .09.2026

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-10516/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Bilal, S/o: Abdul Rahim R/o: H.No. 6/26, Gali No. 1, Kabir Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 88/2018, U/S: 379/34 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Bilal**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Bilal**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Bilal**, of **FIR No. 88/2018, U/S: 379/34 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.10.2026**.

By Order
Rangat Ghirra
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Court No. 19
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/12867/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Tarun, S/o: Hari Krishan, R/o: B-4/276, JJ Colony, Bhalswa, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 156/2012, U/s 25 Arms Act., P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Tarun** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Tarun** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Tarun** accused of case **FIR No. 156/2012, U/s 25 Arms Act., P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class - 06 (North-West)
Court No. 109, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/12407/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
“ Look-Out Notice”.

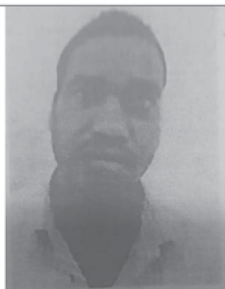
As intimated by SDPO Bari-Brahmana vide letter No. SDPO/BB/26/7925 dated 08.09.2026, that one person namely **BuddhuRary S/o CheduLal R/o Chattisgarh A/P TelliBasti, Bari-Brahmana**, has been missing from Bari-Brahmana and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.18 dated 28.04.2026 of P/S Bari-Brahmana. His search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp@samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Bari-Brahmana:- 8713023636

The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:-

Name:	BuddhuRary	
S/O	CheduLal	
Permanent Address:	Chattisgarh A/P TelliBasti, Bari-Brahmana	
Age:	45 yrs	
Height:	5 Feet06 Inch	
Complexion	Wheatish	
Face:	ROUND, thin	
Body Structure:	Medium	
Language known:	HINDI	
Attire:	Pent Shirt in Blue Colour	

No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated:- .09.2026

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-10514/26

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
“ LOOK OUT NOTICE”

As intimated by SDPO Bari-Brahmana vide letter No. SDPO/BB/26/7925 dated 08.09.2026, that one person namely **Jonny S/o Hans Raj R/o Meen Sarkar Tehsil Bari-Brahmana**, has been missing from Bari-Brahmana and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.13 dated 12.05.2026 of P/S Bari-Brahmana. His search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts.

1. PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp@samba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Bari-Brahmana:- 8713023636

The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:-

Name:	Jonny	
S/O	Hans Raj	
Permanent Address:	R/o Meen Sarkar Tehsil Bari-Brahmana	
Age:	35 yrs	
Height:	5 Feet	
Complexion	Wheatish	
Face:	ROUND	
Body Structure:	Medium	
Language known:	HINDI	
Attire:	White Shirt with black spots and blue trouser	

No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated:- .09.2026

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-10473/26

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: 7620262027 Date: 11.09.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **13:30 hrs. on 07.10.2026**. The details of the tenders are as under:-

S.No.: 1	Tender No.: 165
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Name of Work: TSR(P) By Contractor's own portal with Flash Butt welding in the section Under Sr. DENI/PRYJ.

Approx Cost of work (Rs.): ₹ 13,50,59,120.30	Bid Security (Rs.): ₹ 27,01,200.00
Completion Period: 12 Months	Date of Opening of Tender: 07.10.2026

Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Any P. Way Work. **Note:- With Special condition in tender:** (I) The Tenderer/Bidder shall submit an affidavit regarding ownership/availability of minimum 02 (Two) PQRS/SQRS/TLE machines for working in running track during traffic block and 02 (Two) Gantries for operation at the PQRS depot. (II) The successful Bidder must submit a notarized Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with a firm possessing a Flash Butt Welding plant with a RDSO-approved Quality Assurance Plan (QAP) within 45 days of the issuance of the Letter of Acceptance (LOA). Failure to comply with this requirement will result in the immediate rescission of the contract Or the tenderer shall submit a Declaration owning a Flash Butt Plant with RDSO Approved QAP.

S.No.: 2	Tender No.: 166
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Name of Work: Provision of retro reflective indicator board in the section of Sr. DENI/PRYJ.

Approx Cost of work (Rs.): ₹ 51,58,714.00	Bid Security (Rs.): ₹ 1,03,200.00
Completion Period: 12 Months	Date of Opening of Tender: 07.10.2026

Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Any work involving retro reflective signage boards.

Note:- (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders is available on website www.ireps.gov.in up to **13:30 hrs.** on the due date of tender opening i.e. **07.10.2026**. The tender shall be opened at or after **15:00 hrs.** on due date of opening. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. (4) **Tender No. 165 to 166** are having addressed value more than **50 Lakhs**, therefore, Annexure-V & (V/A) (Document Verification Certificate) is required. The supplier/contractor of goods and /or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. (5) This tender notice has also been uploaded on www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. (6) In case of any difficulty helpline available on the website of IREPS may be approached. (7) Tender online can be submitted up to **13:30 hrs. on 07.10.2026**. (8) E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. (9) For **Tender No. 165 to 166**: The tenderers have to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of IRGCC-2022 (Works matter) mandatorily, otherwise their offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered. 2091/26(A)

f North central railways

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www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Himanshu Girdhar, S/o: Gurcharan Das Girdhar, R/o: 17/10, First Floor, Kalkaji, South East, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 71/2020, U/s: 420/406/34 IPC, Police Station Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Himanshu Girdhar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Himanshu Girdhar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Himanshu Girdhar of Police Station Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rangat Ghirra
JMFC-03, Shahdara, 1st Floor, Room No. 19,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12881/NE/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No.: Sr.DEE/RS/ELS/CNB/2026-27/ET-11 Date: 12.09.2026

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer/RS/N.C. Rly./Kanpur, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following open E-Tender for the following work up to Tender Opening Date & Time. The details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: ELS-CNB-2026-27-ET-11, **Name of Work:** Comprehensive Repair, Renewal of propulsion system for three phase Electric Locomotive of ELS/CNB, Qty: 39 Loco sets.

Advertised Value (in ₹): ₹ 11,27,48,996.88 (Rs. Eleven Crore Twenty Seven Lakh Forty Eight Thousand Nine Hundred Ninety Six and Eighty Eight Paise Only).

Bid Security (in ₹): ₹ 22,55,000.00 (Rs. Twenty Two Lakh Fifty Five Thousand Only).

Completion Period of Work: 36 Months | **Tender Document Cost (in ₹):** NIL

Tender Opening Date & Time: 05.10.2026 & 15:30 hrs.

Note:- (1) The complete information along with tender document of above e-Tenders is available on website www.ireps.gov.in up to due date & time of tender opening. (2) Bids, other than in the form of E-Bids, shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Offer rates quoted in the form of e-tender schedule & duly signed digitally shall be final. No other documents related to offer rates shall be entertained. Tenderers are advised not to attach any document related to offer rates (except undertaking(s) asked). These documents shall be treated as NULL and void and shall not be considered for evaluation of offer. (4) Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. (5) This tender notice has also been uploaded on www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. (6) In case of any difficulty helpline available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 2092/26 (MG)

f North central railways

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www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sagar @ Totla, S/o: Satpal, R/o: H.No. 202/22, Sukhbir Ka Makan, Gali No. 06, Railway Line, Jwala Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 446/2022 U/s 380/411 IPC, P.S.: Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sagar @ Totla** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sagar @ Totla** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sagar @ Totla** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 446/2022 U/s 380/411 IPC,P.S.: Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.12.2026**.

By Order
Sh. P. Bhargav Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (East)
Room No. 3, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/12503/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shahrukh @ Faizan, S/o. Afak, R/o. B-Block, Gali No. 19, Shri Ram Colony, Khajuri Khas, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 5531/2015 U/S 379/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S. Khajuri Khas, North East District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Shahrukh @ Faizan** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Shahrukh @ Faizan** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shahrukh @ Faizan**, accused of **FIR No. 5531/2015 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, North East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.10.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Norma Jain,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
North East, Room No. 22, First Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/13060/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. - PRYJ-Sig-409-2026-27 Dated: 11.09.2026

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Co-ordination/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **15:00 hrs. on 06.10.2026**. The details of the Tender is as under:-

SN: 1	Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-409-2026-27
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Approx. Cost of work (In Rs.): Rs. 13355014.28/- (Rs. One Crore Thirty Three Lakhs Fifty Five Thousand Fourteen and Twenty Eight Paise Only)

Name of work: "S&T work for Replacement of old FOB by 3.05M wide new FOB with Ramp for recoupment of Divyangian Facility at Chola & Wair stations of PRYJ Division and S&T work for Raising" of Platform Up to high level for recoupment of shortfall in MEA at Hathras (PF No. 28/3), Barhan (PF No. 1&2), Shikohabad (PF No. 3/4) and Makhhanpur (PF No. 2/3) stations."

Bid Security/Earnest Money (In Rs.): 267100.00 | **Completion period:** 12 Months

Date of Closing of tender: 06.10.2026

2. Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender. 3. **Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Earnest Money as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form. The tenderer(s) should note that, Tenders without earnest money shall be summarily rejected. 4. **Time, date & place of opening of tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre-determined date at **15:30 hours**. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. 5. **Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. 6. **Right of Railway to deal with tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 2098/26(K)

f North central railways

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.L.T.	55, 56, 59, 60, 61, 63, 64 & 65-2026-27-WV
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1. Name of work with its location

55

Standardization of turnouts & maintenance of track infrastructure in various yard in the section of SSE/PWAY/HNZM under ADEN/HNZM.
Similar nature of work:- Any type of track work.

56

Rag picking and removal of muck malba b/w NDLS-JNC, Ring Railway and GALL Lines in the section of SSE/PWAY/HNZM under ADEN/HNZM
Similar nature of work:- Any Civil work other than track work.

59

Balance work of Replacement of dilapidated old washing cum pit line No. 2 & 3 at DEE Depot, under Sr. DEN/V.
Similar nature of work:- Any Civil work involving concreting work.

60

Standardization of turnouts & maintenance of track infrastructure in various yard in the section of SSE/PWAY/TKD and SSE/PWAY/FDB under ADEN/TKD.
Similar nature of work:- Any type of track work.

61

Rag picking work and Removal of Muck Malba in the Section of SSE/PWAY/DEE under ADEN/DEE.
Similar nature of work:- Any Civil work other than track work.

63

Standardization of turnouts & maintenance of track infrastructure in various yard in the section of SSE/PWAY/DEE and SSE/PWAY/GGN under ADEN/DEE.
Similar nature of work:- Any type of track work.

64

Repairs to choked sewerage network and damaged roads, plastering, door, windows in Staff Quarters of Railway colony at Faridabad in the section of SSE/W/FDB under ADEN/TKD.
Similar nature of work:- Any Civil work other than track work.

65

Rag picking work and Removal of Muck Malba in the Section of ADEN/TKD.

2. Approx. Cost of Work

55	₹ 99,99,978.82	56	₹ 89,99,997.02	59	₹ 1,82,75,718.87
60	₹ 1,29,99,953.75	61	₹ 94,99,984.69	63	₹ 1,19,99,999.05
64	₹ 99,99,998.97	65	₹ 44,99,984.72		

3. Earnest Money Deposit

(It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no 201025/CE-I/CT/5/1 dated 31.08.2016)

55	₹ 2,00,000.00	56	₹ 1,80,000.00	59	₹ 3,65,500.00
60	₹ 2,60,000.00	61	₹ 1,90,000.00	63	₹ 2,40,000.00
64	₹ 2,00,000.00	65	₹ 90,000.00		

4. Completion Period of Work

55	06 Months	56	09 Months	59	06 Months
60	06 Months	61	09 Months	63	06 Months
64	06 Months	65	09 Months		

5. Date and Time for Submission of Tender and Opening of Tender

Upto 15:00 hrs on 08.10.2026 Opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. On 08.10.2026.

6. Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.

Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No.: 128-W/280/OET/2026-27-W/V-NIT-55, 56, 59, 60, 61, 63, 64 & 65-2026-27
Date: 14.09.2026 3169/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

BEAT AFGHANISTAN BY 7 WICKETS

Team India clinch T20I series

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 15

Sanju Samson’s explosive 57 off 22 balls and Nitish Kumar Reddy’s three-wicket haul powered India to a commanding seven-wicket win over Afghanistan in the second T20I here on Tuesday, giving the hosts an unassailable lead in the three-match series.

Reddy returned with figures of 3/24, striking on the first ball of each of his three overs, as the Indian bowlers produced another disciplined show to restrict Afghanistan to 159 for 8.

India conceded just 64 between overs 7-14 to leave the Afghans struggling at 105 for six in 15 overs, as it was Mohammad Nabi (20) and Rashid Khan (28) who added crucial 48 runs off 28 balls to take them to a decent total in the end.

Chasing 160, openers Samson and Abhishek Sharma (39) brutalised Afghanistan bowlers with sensational hitting, amassing 82-1 in the mandatory powerplay to set the foundation as India eventually romped home in 14.5 overs.

If Abhishek was the pro-



Nitish Kumar Reddy celebrates after taking the wicket of Afghanistan’s Gulbadin Naib duringT20I match against Afghanistan, in New Delhi on Tuesday

HIGHLIGHTS

» Reddy returned with figures of 3/24, striking on the first ball of each of his three overs

» India conceded just 64 between overs 7-14, to leave the Afghans struggling at 105 for six in 15 overs

» Afghanistan’s ploy to open with spin at both ends backfired

tagonist in the opening T20, it was the 31-year-old Sam-

son who clobbered seven foursand four maximums

en route to his fastest fifty which came off 20 balls, displaying his immaculate timing and rich arsenal of strokes once again.

Afghanistan’s ploy to open with spin at both ends backfired as Abhishek blasted Mujeeb Ur Rahman (3/37) for two fours in the first over, before pulling

Nabi for a six in the second. Samson then picked up a four off Azmatullah Omarzai before Abhishek depositedNabi for his second six in the fourth over as runs came thick and fast.

The Kerala batter exploded in the fifth over as he flicked one off the hips for a six.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Seoul, September 15

India will be without their key doubles player Yuki Bhambri in their Davis Cup Qualifier against South Korea after the veteran was ruled out with a thigh injury, forcing the team to rethink its doubles combination days before the crucial contest.

The winner of this match will advance into the finals.

India captain Rohit Rajpal confirmed that Bhambri will not be available for the Round 2 tie.

“Yuki Bhambri is not doing too well with his thigh and may not be available to play the Davis Cup. So, we are working on that area to see what our combination is going to be, which we shouldn’t be doing actually during the week before the Davis Cup. But unfortunately, we are having to do that,” Rajpal said.

Bhambri had suffered a right thigh strain before his US Open main-draw match and had subsequently been doubtful for the Korea tie.

His absence is a significant blow to India’s doubles plans, with Rajpal



Yuki Bhambri

INDIA CAPTAIN ROHIT RAJPAL CONFIRMED THAT BHAMBRI WILL NOT BE AVAILABLE FOR THE ROUND 2 TIE

having previously paired him with Dhakshineswar Suresh. The combination worked effectively during their previous Davis Cup outing against the Netherlands in Bengaluru.

“Last time I played Yuki and DK because Yuki’s big strength is his return from ad-court.

And that is the weakness for DK. And Yuki’s serve is his weak point and DK has a huge serve. This opposite combination

made them a very formidable pair,” said Rajpal.

“Yuki would do that. And DK being a big guy and a great volleyer would take the pressure off Yuki’s serving. So, the combination worked very well last time for us,” Rajpal said.

India have now been forced to experiment with different doubles combinations, with veteran N Sriman Balaji becoming the team’s leading option after breaking into the world’s top 50 in doubles.

“Bala is playing very, very well. He is going to be the anchor for doubles this time. And as you know, he has yesterday broken into the top 50 in doubles,” Rajpal said.

Chess: Indian teams eye glory for second time running

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Samarkand, September 15

India carry the weight of defending both Chess Olympiad titles with world champion D Gukesh and an in-form R Praggnanandhaa spearheading a men’s team that starts among the favourites, while the women’s side too will look to retain its crown.

Gukesh, however, arrives at the Olympiad at a very different point in his career from the last edition. The 20-year-old has endured a significant dip

in form over the past year and will be keen to use the tournament to regain his rhythm before his World Championship match in November in Switzerland.

Praggnanandhaa, meanwhile, has been one of the standout performers of the year. His remarkable run, which saw him become the first Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour, makes him one of India’s biggest strengths as they chase another Olympiad gold.

The two will be backed by Arjun Erigaisi, who



played a key role in India’s triumph in Budapest in 2024. Vidit Gujrathi brings experience and reliability

to the line-up, while Nihal Sarin adds further depth to a formidable squad.

India’s biggest threats

are expected to come from the United States and hosts Uzbekistan, two teams that have rarely been easy to discount at recent Olympiads.

The US boasts the experience of Fabiano Caruana and Levon Aronian, while Uzbekistan has a talented young squad led by Javokhir Sindarov, who will himself challenge Gukesh for the World Championship later this year.

The Indian women’s team will also defend its title, though the squad looks slightly different this

time with D Harika and Tanja Sachdev absent.

Koneru Humpy will lead from the top board, with World Cup winner Divya Deshmukh and World Championship challenger R Vaishali adding considerable firepower.

The Indian think tank could be tempted to field Divya on the second board given her higher rating, but her aggressive style, instinct and ability to consistently score points could make her particularly valuable on board three.

India Women ‘A’ lose to Australia ‘A’ by 30 runs

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mullanpur, September 15

Niki Prasad’s all-round show was eclipsed by Katie Mack’s unbeaten 83 as Australia Women ‘A’ beat India ‘A’ by 30 runs to take an unassailable 2-0 lead in the three-match unofficial T20I series here on Tuesday.

Mack’s first-innings exploits pushed Australia ‘A’ to a commanding total of 178 for two, and in reply, India ‘A’ team could only

manage 148 for seven even as Prasad led their fight-back after a top-order collapse. In pursuit of a stiff target, India had slipped to 54/5 inside nine overs. Prasad found support from Minnu Mani (16) at the other end, but even as they managed to steady the ship, the pair could not stage a counter-attack.

After taking 2/41 in the first half, Prasad struck a vital 54 not out (31 balls; 6x4s, 2x6s) but her all-round show went in vain.

झारखण्ड सरकार
खान एवं भूतत्व विभाग खान निदेशालय

शुद्धि पत्र

खान निदेशालय, खान एवं भूतत्व विभाग द्वारा विभिन्न दैनिक समाचार पत्रों में PR No-389611 (Mines and Geology) 26-27*D के माध्यम से दिनांक-12.09.2026 को प्रकाशित अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना में इच्छुक व्यक्ति / स्थानीय निबंधित ट्रेडर एजेंसियों से मासिक / दैनिक किराया पर विशिष्ट वाहनों को ईंधन एवं चालक सहित आवश्यकतानुसार मासिक एवं दैनिक किराया पर परिचालन हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की गयी थी।

उक्त अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना में लिपिकीय भूलवश अंकित सूचना, जो विभिन्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित है, में “निविदा दर्स्तावेज की उपलब्धता **“http://www.jharkhand.gov.in”** के स्थान पर “निविदा दर्स्तावेज की उपलब्धता **“http:// www.minerals.jharkhand.gov.in.”** पढ़ा जाए।”

2.शेष निविदा सूचना, नियम एवं शर्तें यथावत रहेंगे।

हो / –
उप निदेशक, खान (मु०)

PR 389800 (Mines and Geology)26-27*D

जिला परिषद का कार्यालय, प० सिंहभूम, चाईबासा
(Email – zpchaibasa@gmail.com)

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या- ZP/CHAIBASA/09/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :-

युप सं०	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
01.	कुमारझूँगी प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत अंधारी प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
02.	मंडराँव प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत घोडाघोषीनि प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
03.	हाटगम्हरिया प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत हाटगम्हरिया प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
04.	मंडारी प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत पांगा प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
05.	बन्दगाँव प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत दुधकुन्डी प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
06.	गुदड़ी प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत लोढ़ाई प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
07.	नोवागुन्डी प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत नोवागुन्डी प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
08.	चक्रधरपुर प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत हथिया प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केन्द्र का निर्माण।	14255800.00	2,86,000	10000	09 MONTH
09.	तलनगर प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत मुमदापोखर विभाग स्वास्थ्य उपकेन्द्र का निर्माण।	55,50,000	1,11,000	10000	06 MONTH
10.	सोनुवा प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत पोडा स्वास्थ्य उपकेन्द्र का निर्माण।	55,50,000	1,11,000	10000	06 MONTH
11.	सोनुवा प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत पोडाहाट स्वास्थ्य उपकेन्द्र का निर्माण।	55,50,000	1,11,000	10000	06 MONTH
12.	मंडारी प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत कुन्दरुट स्वास्थ्य उपकेन्द्र का निर्माण।	55,50,000	1,11,000	10000	06 MONTH

1. वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – दिनांक- 18.09.2026
2. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय- दिनांक- 18.09.2026 से दिनांक- 03.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।
3. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान- जिला परिषद का कार्यालय, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।
4. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय- दिनांक- 05.10.2026 अपराह्न 02:00 बजे।
5. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता- जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, पश्चिमी सिंहभूम, चाईबासा।
6. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष संख्या – 7209247617 (संबंधित जिला अभियंता का दूरभाष संख्या)
7. परिमाण विपत्र की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है, तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।
8. सरकार के संयुक्त सचिव ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग झारखण्ड सरकार राँची के पत्रांक 02(नि०नि०-17)-251/23 ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग 3130(अनु०), राँची, दिनांक 09.10.2023 द्वारा दिये गये निर्देश के अनुपालन में सभी कामजात के साथ, निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि **Online Mode** द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।
10. निविदा में सिर्फ जिला परिषद, चाईबासा के अन्तर्गत पंजीकृत समुचित श्रेणी के संवेदक ही भाग ले सकेंगे।
11. निविदा डबल बीड पद्धति के आधार पर किया जायेगा।
12. स्थानीय संवेदकों को प्राथमिकता दी जायेगी। किसी भी समय बिना सूचना के निविदा रद्द एवं किसी भी प्रकार का संशोधन करने का अधिकार अद्योखस्ताक्षरी को सुरक्षित रहेगा एवं इस पर किसी प्रकार का दावा या आपत्ति मान्य नहीं होगा।
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए जिला का वेब साईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।
जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद, प० सिंहभूम, चाईबासा
PR 389785 West Singhbhum (26-27)#D

Shree Charani achieves career-best rating

Deepti climbs to No. 2 in rankings

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dubai, September 15

India spinner Shree Charani retained the top spot with career-best rating points, while compatriot Deepti Sharma climbed four places to second in the latest ICC Women’s T20I Player Rankings released here on Tuesday. Charani’s outstanding 4/20 in the Women’s T20 Asia Cup final against Sri Lanka lifted the left-arm spinner above the 800-point mark for the first time to a career-best 804.

These are the highest rating points ever achieved by an Indian in the ICC rankings for both batters and bowlers, surpassing former skipper Mithali Raj’s previous record of 780 points in batting rankings in 2011.

Charani is now just two points short of the highest rating points ever achieved by a women’s T20I bowler, held by Australia’s Megan Schutt in November 2018.

India’s bowling attack was further rewarded with Deepti moving up four places to second after finishing the Asia Cup as the tournament’s leading wicket-taker with 14 scalps.

Seamer Nandani Sharma has climbed 10 places to 94th following an impressive tournament with the ball, while



Deepti Sharma

leg-spinner Prema Rawat has made one of the biggest gains of the week, surging 50 places to 96th.

In batting rankings, Shafali Verma’s outstanding tournament has seen her jump from seventh to sixth. Shafali was the leading run-scorer at the Asia Cup with 236 runs, including scores of 64 in the semifinal and 68 in the final. Shafali now has 741 rating points - her highest since October 2021.

She is just one place and four rating points behind teammate Smriti Mandhana, who sits fifth on 745 points after scoring 213 runs in five innings.

Shafali has also made significant progress in the all-rounders’ rankings, moving up five places to 15th and reaching a career-best 221 rating points.

HI EXECUTIVE BOARD MEET Infighting and Governing Council for HIL on agenda



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 15

The controversy-mired Hockey India has called an emergent Executive Board meeting on September 18 here to resolve the differences among its top officials and restructure the struggling Hockey India League to create an independent Governing Council. HI President Dilip Tirkey and secretary Bhola Nath Singh have not been on the same page for a while following the controversy surrounding the change of Indian teams’ jersey colour from blue to saffron before the recently-concluded FIH World Cup.

Tirkey said the jersey change was done without

THE TURN OF EVENTS HAS PROMPTED SECRETARY BHOLA NATH TO CALL AN EMERGENT EXECUTIVE BOARD MEETING

his knowledge and without the consent of the HI Executive Board.

Subsequently, he sent a show-cause notice to HI Director General, Cdr R K Srivastava and stripped him of all his powers with immediate effect, listing eight charges, with jersey change being the most prominent.

The turn of events has prompted secretary Bhola Nath to call an emergent

Executive Board Meeting. The notice issued by Tirkey gave Srivastava four weeks’ time to submit his reply. “On the advice/direction of the Hockey India President, Dr Dilip Tirkey, received via email dated 14.09.2026, the Emergent - 119th Executive Board Meeting of Hockey India will be held at 15:00 hrs on 18.09.2026 at the Hockey India Office, New Delhi,” Bhola Nath wrote in an e-mail to Executive Board members, a copy of which is in possession of PTL. The meeting was conveyed by HI secretary Bhola Nath but Tirkey in his reply on Tuesday had clearly stated that it is the sole prerogative of the body’s chief to call emergency meeting and not the secretary.

World Athletics Championships to be staged in Africa

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Budapest, September 15

The World Athletics Championships are heading to Africa for the first time as Kenya's capital Nairobi was confirmed Tuesday as host of the 2029 edition of track and field's premier event. Kenya has long been a superpower in distance running and is second on the all-time worlds medal table behind only the United States. The championships return to Germany in 2031 after a 22-year wait, with Munich hosting. "Taking our championships to Africa for the first time will be historic," World Athletics President Sebastian Coe said as he announced the decision following the Ultimate Championship in Hungary. "Athletics is woven into the fabric of Kenya." Salim Mvurya, the Kenyan government minister responsible for sports, said "the

THE CHAMPIONSHIPS RETURN TO GERMANY IN 2031 AFTER A 22-YEAR WAIT, WITH MUNICH HOSTING

world will come to a country where running is more than competition, it is our national story." Coe added World Athletics research had shown Kenya was the most passionate market for track and field among those surveyed. The championships will use a stadium that's already being upgraded for Kenya co-hosting soccer's Africa Cup of Nations next year. "It was important that the World Athletics Championships should come to Africa when we had the right host, the right bid and the right circumstances. Nairobi has demonstrated emphatically that this is their moment," Coe said.

NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, (UP)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <http://etender.up.nic.in> Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. 40/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27, M/o Sewerage (S/o Mustard Oil & Soap in Divisional Store Sector-39) (Supply of Two Year), Noida. Cost Rs. 16.10 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date:- 29.09.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 30.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)

1. 08/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27, M/o W/s (Two Year Annual Maintenance of Water Supply with Some Allied Electrical Work at Gashala in Sector-135), Noida. Cost Rs. 18.75 Lacs

2. 10/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27, M/o Sewerage (Cleaning & Desilting of Deep Sewer line by Super Sucker Machine in Sewerage Network Sector-130, 132, & 135), Noida. Cost Rs. 25.15 Lacs

3. 41/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27, M/o Sewerage (Two Year Cleaning of Internal sewer line by Portable Re-Cycle Jetting Machine in Village-Nagla Nagli, Nagli Sakhpur Rohillapur & Sector-130 & 132), Noida (Total 03 Villages Cleaning work for Two years), Noida. Cost Rs. 27.24 Lacs

4. 42/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27, Equipment and Machinery (Two Years Annual Repairing of Tractor, Trolley and Water Tanker in Jal Division-I), Noida. Cost Rs. 27.25 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date:- 22.09.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened / downloaded on date:- 23.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Jal) Noida

Office Sector-5 Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

GOVT OF MAHARASHTRA

Public work Divisiou No.2, Jalna

E-Tender Notice No. 07 - 2026-2027

Online tender (e-tenders) for following works are invited by the Executive Engineer public Works Division No2, Jalna in B-1 Tender (online) for (02) works in Jalna Dist. The contractor Registered with the Public work department/company/ form / in appropriate class shall be issued by the Executive Engineer public Works Division Jalna

1. All the details regarding e-tenders procedure and tender documents are available on e-tenders portal Of PWD department of Government of Maharashtra <https://mahatenders.gov.in> and <http://mahapwd.gov.in>

2. in case any changes in the Tenders /Tenders Notice, the same shall be informed through the abovementioned web Portals

3. All the right accept or reject the tenders are reserved with Executive Engineer public Works Division No2 Jalna Conditional tenders shall be summarily rejected

Sd/-Executive Engineer Public Work Division No.2, Jalna

Dgipr/2026-27/2843

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON (See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Vikas Agarwal, R/o Proprietor Kengain Distribution India, F-28, Patel Nagar III, Ghaziabad, U.P. 201001 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case Ct Case No. 3928/2017 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Subhash Place, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Vikas Agarwal cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Vikas Agarwal has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Vikas Agarwal of Ct Case No. 3928/2017 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Subhash Place, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 15.10.2026.

By Order Ms. Nitika Judicial Magistrate First Class, (NI Act) Room No. 110, North-West District Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13093/NW/2026

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS! IMPORTANT INFORMATION

RUN OF MORE FESTIVAL SPECIAL TRAINS-2026

In order to clear extra rush of passengers during this Festival Season, Railways have decided to run the following additional Festival Special Trains as per details given below:

04072/04071 New Delhi - Supaul - New Delhi Reserved Special Express 118 Trips

Train No. 04072 STATIONS Train No. 04071

ARR. DEP. ARR. DEP.

21:35 New Delhi 15:00

06:35 Supaul 07:45

Days of run :- 04072 Ex. New Delhi on everyday from 01.10.2026 to 28.11.2026 and 04071 Ex. Supaul on everyday from 03.10.2026 to 30.11.2026.

Composition : 3 Tier AC, Sleeper and General.

Stoppages: Ghaziabad, Aligarh Jn., Tundla Jn., Etawah Jn., Govindpur, Prayagraj Jn., Gyanpur Road., Varanasi Jn., Aunrihar Jn., Ghazipur City, Ballia, Suraimanpur, Chhapra, Sonpur, Hajipur Jn., Shahpur Patoree, Barauni Jn., Begusarai, Khagaria Jn., Mansi Jn., Simri Bakhtiyarpur & Saharsa Jn. Stations.

04212/04211 Sultanpur - Lokmanya Tilak (T.) - Sultanpur Reserved Special Express 08 Trips

Train No. 04212 STATIONS Train No. 04211

ARR. DEP. ARR. DEP.

04:00 23:00

06:20 06:30 Lucknow 20:50 21:00

14:00 Lokmanya Tilak Terminus 15:00

Days of run :- 04212 Ex. Sultanpur on every Wednesday from 21.10.2026 to 11.11.2026 and 04211 Ex. Lokmanya Tilak Terminus on every Thursday from 22.10.2026 to 12.11.2026.

Composition : 3 Tier AC Economy and General.

Stoppages: Kanpur central, Orai, Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi, Bina, Rani Kamalapati, Itarsi Jn., Khandwa, Bhusaval, Nasik Road, Igatpuri, Kalyan & Thane Stations.

04226/04225 Varanasi - Lokmanya Tilak (T.) - Varanasi Reserved Special Express 08 Trips

Train No. 04226 STATIONS Train No. 04225

ARR. DEP. ARR. DEP.

01:35 Varanasi Jn. 02:05

06:20 06:30 Lucknow 20:50 21:00

14:00 Lokmanya Tilak Terminus 15:00

Days of run :- 04226 Ex. Varanasi Jn. on every Thursday from 22.10.2026 to 12.11.2026 and 04225 Ex. Lokmanya Tilak Terminus on every Friday from 23.10.2026 to 13.11.2026.

Composition : 3 Tier AC Economy and General.

Stoppages: Jaunpur City, Sultanpur, Kanpur Central, Orai, Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi, Bina, Rani Kamalapati, Itarsi Jn., Khandwa, Bhusaval, Nasik Road, Igatpuri, Kalyan & Thane Stations.

04314/04313 Yog Nagari Rishikesh-Muzaffarpur -Yog Nagari Rishikesh Reserved Special Express 36 Trips

Train No. 04314 STATIONS Train No. 04313

ARR. DEP. ARR. DEP.

15:20 Yog Nagari Rishikesh 11:15

11:45 Muzaffarpur Jn. 13:15

Days of run :- 04314 Ex. Yog Nagari Rishikesh on every Sunday & Thursday from 01.10.2026 to 29.11.2026 and 04313 Ex. Muzaffarpur Jn. on every Monday & Friday from 02.10.2026 to 30.11.2026.

Composition : 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper and General.

Stoppages: Haridwar Jn., Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjahanpur, Sitapur, Gondal, Gorakhpur, Kaplagnanj, Bagaha, Narkataganj, Bettiah, Sada, Bapudham Motihari, Muzaffarpur Jn., Samastipur Jn., Barauni Jn., Kiul Jn., Jhajha, Jaisidh Jn., Madhupur Jn., Chittaranjan, Asansol Jn., Durgapur & Bardhaman Stations.

04052/04051 New Delhi - Howrah- New Delhi Reserved Special Express 18 Trips

Train No. 04052 STATIONS Train No. 04051

ARR. DEP. ARR. DEP.

18:15 New Delhi 08:20

23:40 Howrah Jn. 01:40

Days of run :- 04052 Ex. New Delhi on every Friday from 02.10.2026 to 27.11.2026 and 04051 Ex. Howrah Jn. on every Sunday from 04.10.2026 to 29.11.2026.

Composition : 3 Tier AC, Sleeper and General.

Stoppages: Ghaziabad, Aligarh Jn., Tundla Jn., Govindpur, Prayagraj Jn., Mirzapur, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Jn., Buxar, Ara, Patna Jn., Bakhtiyarpur Jn., Kiul Jn., Jhajha, Jaisidh Jn., Madhupur Jn., Chittaranjan, Asansol Jn., Durgapur, Bardhaman & Bandel Stations.

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in

Download RailMadad app.

PUBLIC NOTICE

We, Deepak, son of Mr Vinod Kumar, and Mrs. Kusum, wife of Mr. Deepak, residents of S-588, Saran Village, Faridabad, have Kashish, our biological daughter, who is out of our control and does not listen to us or any member of our family, and behaves rudely and disrespectfully towards us on a daily basis. Our aforementioned daughter has left home without informing us, and we have no information about her. We hereby sever all ties with our aforementioned daughter and disinherit her from all our movable and immovable properties, wherever they are located in India. If anyone has any kind of relationship, connection, dealings, transactions, or transactions with our aforementioned daughter, or takes out any loan, etc., they will be solely responsible for the same. We or any member of our family will not be responsible for any of this.

Applicants - Deepak, Kusum

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

It is for general information that I, Gaurav Kumar Gahlot S/o Shri Ashok Kumar Gahlot R/o H.No. 1/2272, Gali No.6, Near Indera Piyaau, East Ram Nagar, Mandoli Road, Shahdara, Delhi- 110032, declare that name of my minor daughter has been wrongly written as KANISHKA GAHLOT, age 12 years, in her school records, The actual name of my minor daughter is KANISHKA, Which may be amended accordingly.

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

Telephone No.01893-256602 Email-ee-fat-hp@nic.in

The Executive Engineer HPPWD Division, Fatehpur Dist Kangra H.P. on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the Percentage Rate bid in electronic tendering system from the eligible Class of contractors registered in HPPWD for the works as detailed in the table.

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost	Starting date for down leading bid	Earnest Money	Deadline for submission of bid	Time limit	Cost of Tender	Eligible class of Contractor
1	Construction of Health sub Center building at Kandrol Tehsil Fatehpur Dist Kangra (HP) (SH). Construction of building portion, water supply and sanitary installation, Septic tank, Rain water Harvesting tank and soak pit.	Rs.72,24,445/-	18.09.2026	Rs.144500/-	25.09.2026	One Year	Rs. 2000/-	C&B

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in. Date of Opening of Executive Engineer Fatehpur Division HPPWD, Fatehpur Tele:-01893-256602 e-mail-ee-fat-hp@nic.in On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh

Ro.No 3399/2026-2027

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Home Finance Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai- 400051

Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059 Branch Office: 307/1, 1st Floor, Bishnoi Tower, Mangal Pandey Nagar, Opposite Apex Tower, Meerut- 250004

Whereas The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/ her under Section 13(14) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited. The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Loan Account Number	Description of property/ Date of Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Abdulhai Saifi (Borrower), Gulista, (Co-Borrower), Kamhera Dhanasari Muzaffarnagar- 251314 Uttar Pradesh, LHIMRT00001535514	A Plot, Situated At Mohalla Saddik Nagar, Ward No. 23 (Nagar Palika No 190), Kasba, Pargana And Tahsil Khatauli, District Muzaffarnagar-251001 Uttar Pradesh, Total Area 99.28 Sq. Yds, i.e. 83.01 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By:- North By: 20ft 3 Inch Then 12ft 6inch Road, South By: 14ft 10inch Then Peroperty of Lalaji, East By: 52ft 6 Inch Then H/o Sarik, West By: 49 Ft 6 Inch Then H/o Murtza./ Date of Possession 10-Sep-26	11-06-2026 Rs. 51,208.1/-	Meerut
2.	Abdulhai Saifi (Borrower), Gulista, (Co-Borrower), Kamhera Dhanasari Muzaffarnagar- 251314 Uttar Pradesh, LHIMRT00001535650	A Plot, Situated At Mohalla Saddik Nagar, Ward No. 23 (Nagar Palika No. 190), Kasba, Pargana And Tahsil Khatauli, District Muzaffarnagar-251001 Uttar Pradesh, Total Area 99.28 Sq. Yds, i.e. 83.01 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By:- North By: 20ft 3 Inch Then 12ft 6inch Road, South By: 14ft 10inch Then Peroperty of Lalaji, East By: 52ft 6 Inch Then H/o Sarik, West By: 49 Ft 6 Inch Then H/o Murtza./ Date of Possession 10-Sep-26	11-06-2026 Rs. 7,30,266/-	Meerut

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under the Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 16, 2026 Place: Muzaffarnagar

Authorized Office, ICICI Home Finance Company Limited

झारखंड सरकार

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, क्षेत्र सर्वेक्षण प्रमण्डल, अग्रिम योजना, पथ निर्माण विभाग, चौथा तल्ला, निरुपण भवन, डोएण्डा, राँची। e-mail--- eercdaps@dran-jhr@nic.in

शुद्धि-पत्र

एतद द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि कार्यालय द्वारा निर्गत e-Tender Reference No -RCD/FSD/AP/RAN /09/26-27 Dated 03.09.2026 जिसका पी0आर0न0 389026 Road (26-27) # D है, अपरिहार्य कारणों से रद्द किया जाता है। कार्यपालक अभियंता, क्षेत्र सर्वेक्षण प्रमण्डल, अग्रिम योजना, पथ निर्माण विभाग, राँची। PR.NO.389727 Road(26-27):D

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006 Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508 CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

Letter No: 813 E- Tender Notice Date: 15/09/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Maint.), Chibro Power Station, invites online bids from interested parties.

(1) E-Tender No: CH(Maint.)-24/2026-27 Major Overhauling of Main Inlet Valve (MIV) of 60 MW Unit No. 04 at Chibro Power Station. Estimated cost- (1) Rs. 1,73,05,979/- (GST extra)

Date of availability of bid document on website- 15.09.2026, 18:00 hrs. Last date for submission of bid on website- 06.10.2026 up to 16:00 hrs. For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in" (Executive Engineer, Maint., Chibro)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

NORTHERN RAILWAY CORRIGENDUM

Ref : Tender Notice No. - 16/2026-2027 Dated - 27.05.2026 Sr. no. 06 (I) Tender No. - 15235293A due on 13.10.2026

1. In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 15.09.2026 to 13.10.2026. All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3184/26

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. AGC/M/Vendor list/Serv. Contract/26 Date : 14.09.2026

Expression of Interest (EOI)

Expression of Interest (EOI) for preparing a list of approved vendors for Mechanized coach cleaning & OBHS work at coaching depots; Location: Any coaching depot within the Agra Division.

An Expression of Interest (EOI) is invited to prepare a list of approved vendors for providing Mechanized coach cleaning & OBHS services at any coaching depots situated within the Agra Division of North Central Railway. Interested agencies/individuals may submit their applications, complete with all details in the prescribed format, to the office of the Senior Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Chg.), Divisional Railway Manager's Office, North Central Railway, Agra - 282001. The last date and time for the submission of applications is 15.10.2026 by 15:00 hours. For detailed information and guidelines regarding participation, please visit the official website of North Central Railway at www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in.

For any information or clarification regarding this matter, the following officials may be contacted:

Shri Shivendra Singh, SSE/Tender (Mobile: 9760537257)

Shri Abhishek Raman, DME/O&F/Agra (Mobile: 9760536404) 2100/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA "HUE & CRY NOTICE.

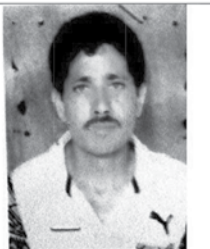
As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide letter No. 25/25/5-1/PSS dated 10.09.2026, that one person namely Vijay Kumar S/o Shallo Ram R/o KalohaGoran Tehsil and district Sambawent missing from samba, but thereafter he did not return home, his search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date, and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.03 dated 25.08.2017 of P/S Samba. Through the medium of this Hue and cry notice, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts.

1. PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Samba:- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:-

Name:	Vijay Kumar	Sd/-
Parentent	S/o Shallo Ram	
Permanent Address:	RR/o KalohaGoran Tehsil and distt Samba	
Age:	45 YRS	
Height:	5'8"	
Complexion	Wheatish	
Face:	Round	
Body Structure:	Normal	
Language:	Dogri	
Attire:	Pent Shirt	
No. CB/Look/2026/	Dated: - 09.2026	

Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

DIP No:DIP/J-10518/26

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA E-mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 03-09-2026, one person namely Des Raj S/O Khazan Chand R/O Village Dilwan Tehsil & District Kathua lodged a written report at P/S Lakhnapur stating therein that his wife namely Anju Devi, age 35 years went missing from home on 25-08-2026. The complainant tried his best to search for his wife but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 20 dated 03-09-2026 has been entered at Police Station Lakhnapur. During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)

2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)

3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)

4. Police Station Lakhnapur - 01922-285028

5. SHO PS Lakhnapur-9186316017

Sd/-Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

DIP No:DIP/J-10461/26



'WIDOW'S BAY' BREAKS EMMY'S RECORD

'The Pitt' won 'Best Drama Series' for the second straight year

A 'Widow's Bay' wave slammed into the Emmy Awards on Monday night as the 'Apple TV' show set a single-season record for a comedy with 14 wins, including 'Best Comedy Series' and 'Best Actor' for star Matthew Rhys, who personally took home three trophies.

'The Pitt' won 'Best Drama Series' for the second straight year and star Noah Wyle repeated as 'Best Actor' in a drama, but the 'HBO Max' emergency room drama won no other Emmys and underperformed expectations.

Rhea Seehorn won 'Best Actress in a Drama' for 'Pluribus' and Jean Smart won her fifth 'Best Actress in a Comedy' award for the fifth and final season of 'Hacks'. No actor had won an Emmy every year for a series which lasted more than three seasons until Smart did it Monday.

Every other comedy award went to 'Widow's Bay', which unequivocally owned the night and broke the comedy series record set last year by 'The Studio' when it won 13 as another first-year 'Apple TV' show.

The weird 'Widow's Bay' sweeps across categories. Along with 'Best Actor in a Comedy', Rhys won 'Best Actor in a Limited Series' for 'The Beast in Me', becoming the first man to win two leading actor categories in the same year and he gets one of the 'Best Comedy Series' trophies as an executive producer for 'Widow's Bay'.

"Thank you, 'Apple', for letting us take this crazy, creative swing," Dippold said as she accepted the 'Best Drama' award. "They truly just let us do this weird show." It also won for directing by Hiro Murai and for writing by its creator Dippold, a first-time Emmy winner and first-time nominee who was previously best known for an old viral tweet showing her dressed as 'The Babadook'.

The show had won eight Emmys in a previous ceremony before sweeping all six of its categories. Stephen Root won 'Best Supporting Actor in a Comedy Series' and Kate O'Flynn won 'Best Supporting Actress'.

'The Pitt' and 'Hacks' fail to run up numbers. 'The Pitt' was the top drama nominee with 25 and 'Hacks' was the top comedy nominee with



24 for its outgoing season, but neither made much of a splash when it came time to claim trophies.

Smart's win was the only win for 'Hacks' on Monday night. "What a ride this has been," an emotional Smart said after getting a standing ovation.

The 75-year-old has won eight Emmys overall in a career that was already more than respectable when she landed her defining role of Deborah Vance, a brash stand-up comic pushing back against age, obscurity and sexism in the 'HBO Max' series. And 'Best Drama' and 'Best Actor' were the only wins for 'The Pitt', though it had won four at an earlier ceremony.



Wyle won for playing Dr Michael 'Robby' Robi-navitch, a role that brought him a major career revival after starring in 'ER' in the 1990s. "This is all I've ever wanted to do and this is the only club I've ever wanted to join," Wyle said in his acceptance.

'The Pitt' lost in both supporting acting categories despite having four nominees in one of them and three in the other. Wyle said backstage that they'd all be back at work in the morning and they're already midway through this season.

Seehorn gets her first Emmy, Janney and Pelphrey beat Pitt's competition. Seehorn won her first Emmy for playing the lone central character on Apple TV's 'Pluribus'. The 54-year-old had been nominated twice without winning for her breakthrough

at the center of 'Pluribus'. Gilligan won his fifth career Emmy for his writing on the show.

Allison Janney won 'Best Supporting Actress in a Drama' for 'The Diplomat' and Tom Pelphrey won 'Supporting Actor in a Drama' for 'Task', both beating several nominees from 'The Pitt'.

'Widow's Bay' gets rewarded for its elite cast 'Widow's Bay' brought a murderer's row of actors to work on the show, a combination of younger, well-respected unknowns and widely known and beloved veterans.

O'Flynn, a 40-year-old British actress whose previous acclaim came mostly for her work in theatre, plays Patricia Moyer, a city worker and social outcast dealing with a demonic darkness on 'Widow's Bay'.

Root, one of the most ubiquitous character actors of the last few decades, beat out Harrison Ford, who many thought would get his first major competitive Hollywood award for his role on 'Shrinking'. Sally Field, 79, became the oldest woman to win 'Best Actress in a Limited or Anthology Series or TV Movie' for 'Remarkably Bright Creatures'. Colbert wins after cancellation

again. 'The Late Show with Stephen Colbert', taken off the air by CBS, won 'Best Variety Series'. It's one of six Emmys the show has won this year after the show was cancelled for what the network said were economic reasons, while many believe it was his criticism of the Trump administration.

Mariska Hargitay opened the NBC telecast with a musical tribute to television viewing, 'I Love TV Screens', sung to the tune of 'I Love Rock 'n' Roll'. A recorded video featured NBA champion Jalen Brunson of the 'New York Knicks' and actress Jennifer Coolidge.

Macaulay Culkin remembered Catherine O'Hara as more than the actor who played his mother in the 'Home Alone' films. To him, she was simply 'mama'. He joined O'Hara's 'Schitt's Creek' co-stars Annie Murphy and Dan Levy on stage for an emotional tribute to the revered comic actor, who died on January 30 at age 71. "She wasn't just a wife to Bo (Welch) and mother to Matthew and Luke," Culkin said. "She was my mom. She was our mama and by extension, she's all of our mama."

Culkin urged viewers to call their mothers and recalled how O'Hara continued to show up for him decades after they started together in two 'Home Alone' movies.



JEAN SMART WON HER FIFTH 'BEST ACTRESS IN A COMEDY' AWARD FOR THE FIFTH AND FINAL SEASON OF 'HACKS'

BOX OFFICE COLLECTIONS

'Mirzapur: The Movie' beats 'Bhooth Bangla'

'Mirzapur' is still faring much better than 'Haiwaan'

After a strong opening week marked by phenomenal collections, director Gurmmeet Singh's Pankaj Tripathi-led 'Mirzapur: The Movie' has slowed down at the box office. However, it's still faring much better than Priyadarshan's 'Haiwaan' and earned more than seven times what the Saif Ali Khan-Akshay Kumar starrer made on Monday.

On September 14, 'Mirzapur' recorded an India net collection of Rs 5.50 crore across 7,014 shows, bringing its total domestic earnings to Rs 190.20 crore, according to industry tracker 'Sacnilk'. Although its Monday earnings dipped 58.5 per cent from Sunday (Rs 13.25 crore), the crime thriller is still holding strong and has thus far grossed Rs 273.64 crore globally.

With this, the movie has surpassed Priyadarshan's Akshay Kumar starrer 'Bhooth Bangla' (Rs 270.91 crore) as the fourth highest-grossing Hindi film



ON SEPTEMBER 14, 'MIRZAPUR' RECORDED AN INDIA NET COLLECTION OF RS 5.50 CRORE ACROSS 7,014 SHOWS

of the year. It currently trails director Vishal Chaturvedi's 'Hanuman Ansh' (Rs 277.80 crore).

On Monday, 'Mirzapur' witnessed an overall occupancy of 26.82 per cent in the Hindi market. While morning shows opened at just 12.62 per cent occupancy, the rate fluctuated throughout the day, reaching 30.92 per cent in the afternoon, dipping slightly to 30.31 per cent in the evening and nosediving to 27.85 per cent during night screenings.

AGENCIES

Shah Rukh Khan confirms 'King' release date

The film is set to be released on December 24

Shah Rukh Khan hasn't had a release since 2023's 'Dunki' and this year, the fans will get to see him again in Siddharth Anand's 'King'. The film is set to be released on December 24 and fans of the star have been wondering if he might change the release date, considering Marvel's highly anticipated 'Avengers Doomsday' is releasing days before 'King'.

Shah Rukh, in a recent 'Ask Me Anything' (AMA) session, cleared the air and declared that King's release date won't be changing. 'Avengers Doomsday' and 'Dune 3', both highly promoted Hollywood films, are releasing on December 18. He was asked if his son Ahaan will watch 'Doomsday' first or 'King', to which SRK responded, "Pehle to Baap hi aayega beta!! (It will be the father first)."



A fan asked SRK about King's release date and tweeted, "Sir, 'King' is stuck between a sandwich. Change in release date?" SRK replied, "Not at all.... Baaki bread pieces ka bhi toh socho.... Hum toh centre ki tasty tikki hain. (Think of the other pieces. We are the filling of the sandwich.)"

Asked what the hardest part was of shooting the film, Shah Rukh said he suffered some injuries. "Had a few injuries while shooting, so had to start-stop many times, but now all broken is fixed... and nearly all done... so all good."

SRK was also asked about reuniting with Deepika Padukone and Rani Mukerji on 'King'. "The best ever. It's lovely always to work with my best friends," he said.

AGENCIES



'AVENGERS DOOMSDAY' AND 'DUNE 3', BOTH HIGHLY PROMOTED HOLLYWOOD FILMS, ARE RELEASING ON DECEMBER 18